

Restricted Access Species Data Service - User Guide for Data Requestors and Data Custodians

Version 1.0

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Contents

Introduction ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.3
1. How to Register ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.4
1.1 User Roles ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.4
1.2 Register as a Data Custodian ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.5
1.3 Register as a Data Requestor ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.7
2. How to Find Datasets ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.10
2.1 Searching by Keyword ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.11
2.2 Searching by Title or Description ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.12
2.3 Searching by Location ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.12
2.4 Searching by Data Custodian ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.13
3. How to Request Data ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.15
3.1 Selecting data to request ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.15
3.2 The data request form ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.17
4. Checking the Status of Your Data Requests ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.20
5. How to Process Data Requests ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.24
6. How to Add or Edit Metadata ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.27
6.1 Adding a new metadata statement ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.28
6.2 Updating / editing an existing metadata statement ..... Error! Bookmark not defined.29

Introduction

This document has been prepared to assist registered data custodians and data requestors to use the Restricted Access Species Data Service.

For assistance with using the RASDS or if you have any questions, comments or feedback please contact the RASDS Administration Team on info@rasd.org.au.

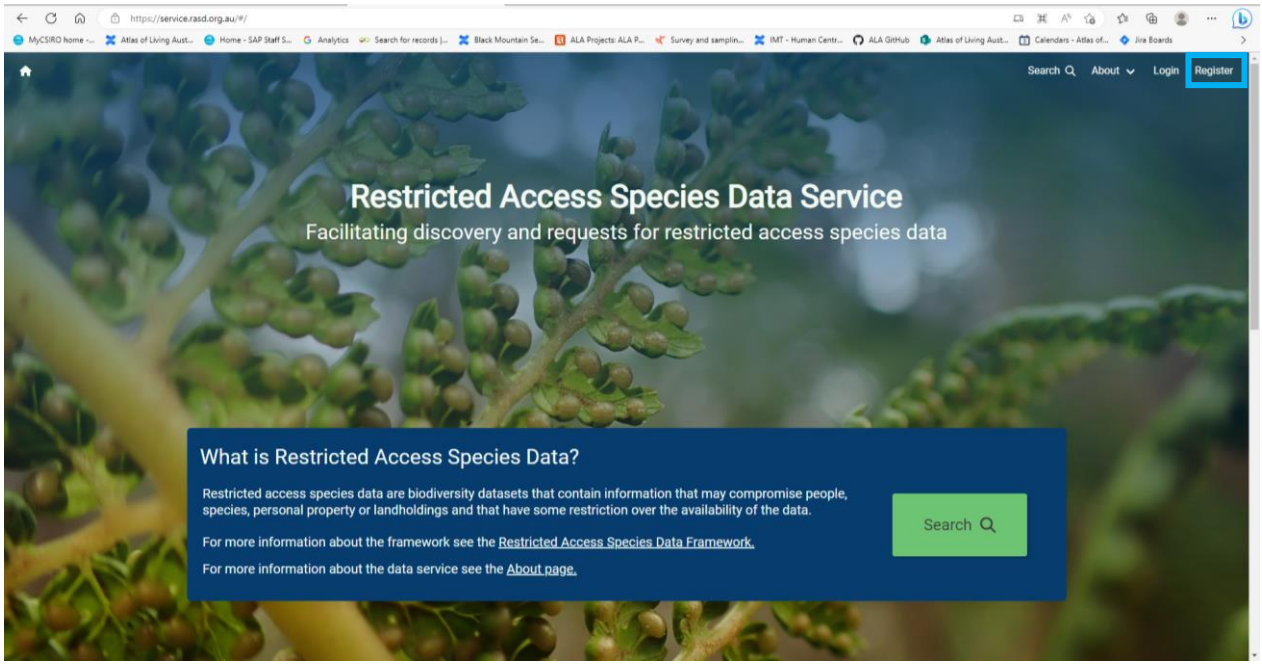
More information about and principles for managing restricted access species data (RASD) in Australia can be found in the National Framework for the Sharing of Restricted Access Species Data in Australia.



1. How to Register

Australian Banded Digger *(Amegilla cingulara)*, © Erst Weiher

From the Restricted Access Species Data Service (RASDS) home page (RASD) click on the “Register” button (highlighted by a light blue box in the image below) which will take you to the initial registration entry page.

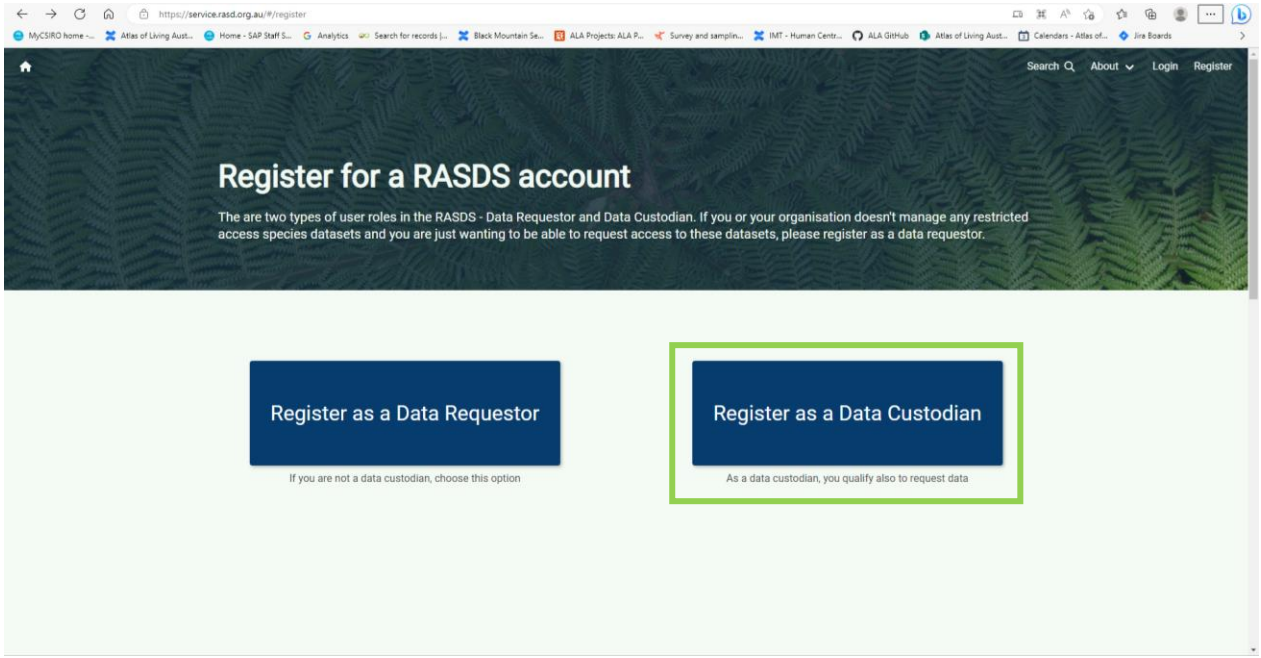


1.1 User Roles

You will see that there are two types of user roles in the RASDS - Data Requestor and Data Custodian (see screenshot below). If you or your organisation doesn't manage any restricted access species datasets and you are just wanting to be able to request access to these datasets, please register as a data requestor. If you hold or managed Restricted Access Species Datasets, please register as a Data Custodian.

NOTE: That to register as either a Data Requestor or a Data Custodian you must be affiliated with a registered business / organisation or authorised to act on its behalf.

NOTE: by registering as a Data Custodian, you automatically also get assigned the role of Data Requestor as well.



1.2 Register as a Data Custodian

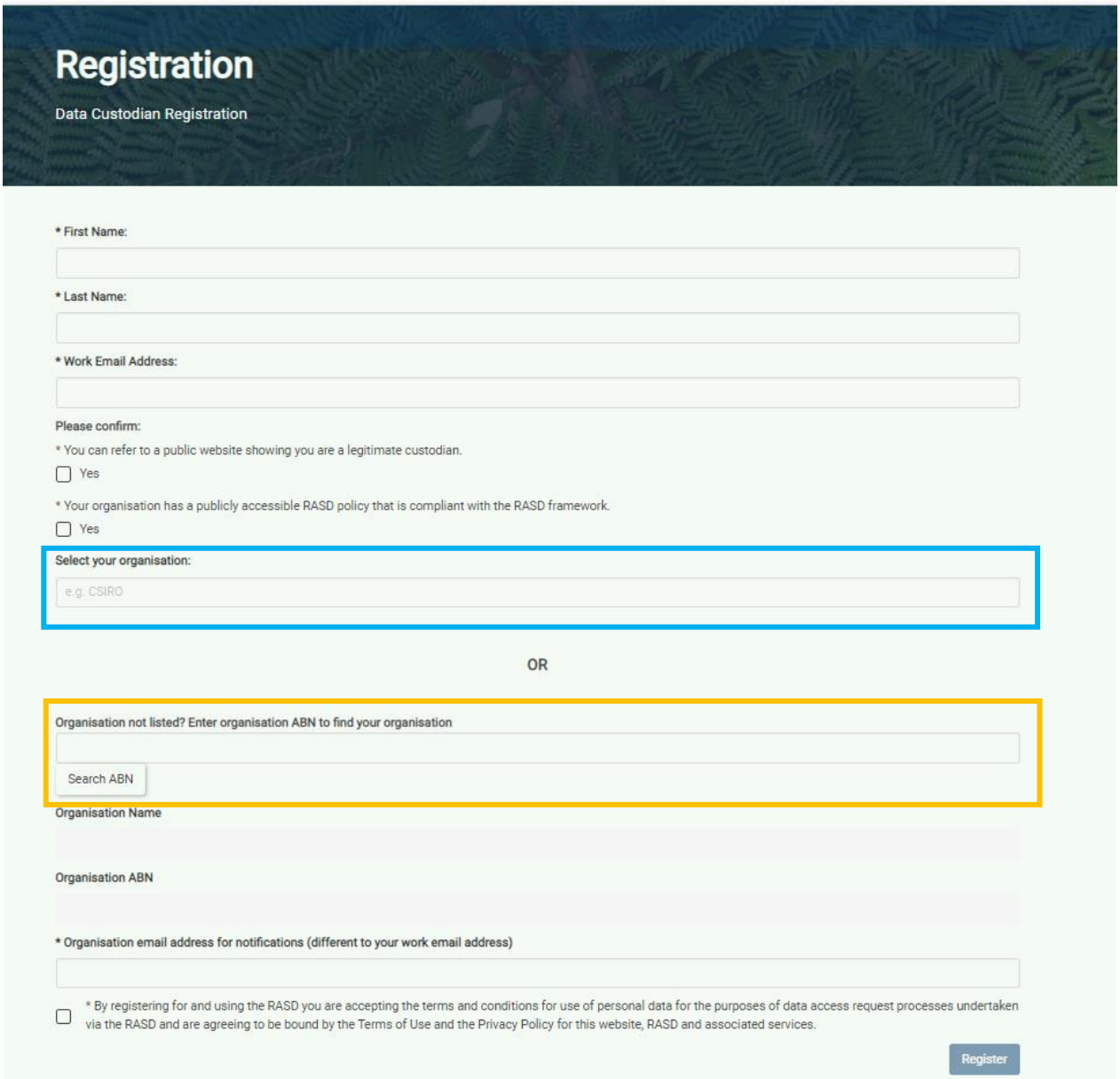
If you wish to register as a Data Custodian (and by default as a Data Requestor), click on the "Register as a Data Custodian" button on the registration entry page (highlighted in green above). You will be taken to the Data Custodian Registration form (shown below).

All fields marked with an asterisk (*) are mandatory. Enter your first and last name, your individual work email address and check the tick boxes relating to your organisation's legitimacy as a data custodian and compliance with the RASD Framework.

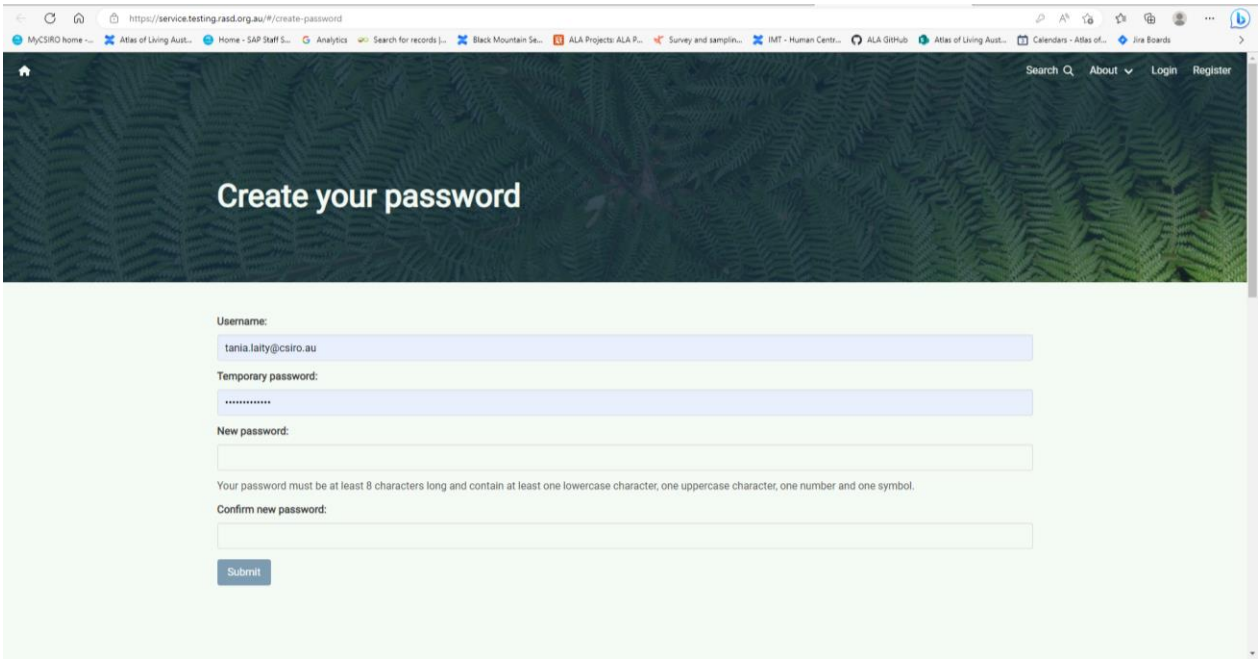
You are now required to either select your organisation from a list of already registered organisations or if your organisation is not listed, enter the ABN of your organisation. To check if your organisation is already registered or to select an already listed organisation, start typing in your organisation's name in the box highlighted in light blue below. If your organisation is already registered, select your organisation from the list. If your organisation is not registered, there will be no matches and you will have to add it using the ABN. If you do not know your organisation's ABN, you can look it up on the ABN Lookup website. Copy and paste your organisation's ABN exactly from the ABN Lookup website into the box highlighted orange on the screenshot below and click on the Search ABN button. The name and ABN of your organisation should automatically be filled in and your organisation added to the RASDS.

Click on the acceptance of terms and conditions check box to complete the form. You will have to click onto a blank area of the form and the Register button will become activated to

enable you to submit the form (this will only happen if ALL mandatory fields have been completed.).

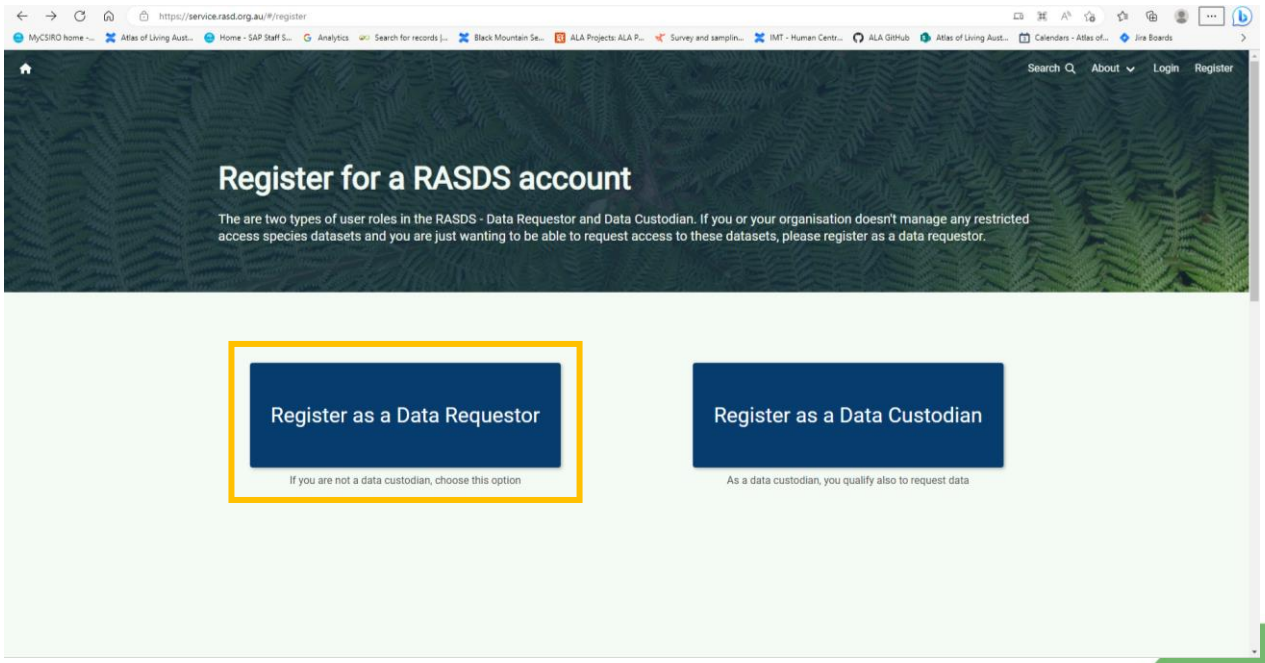


Once you have submitted your registration request, you will be redirected to the home page and you should see a message notifying you that your request has been received. The RASDS Administrators will review your request and either approve or decline it. If approved, you will receive an email with a temporary, one-time password to log in to the system. Click on the link in this email and you will be able to create a new permanent password (see screenshot below).



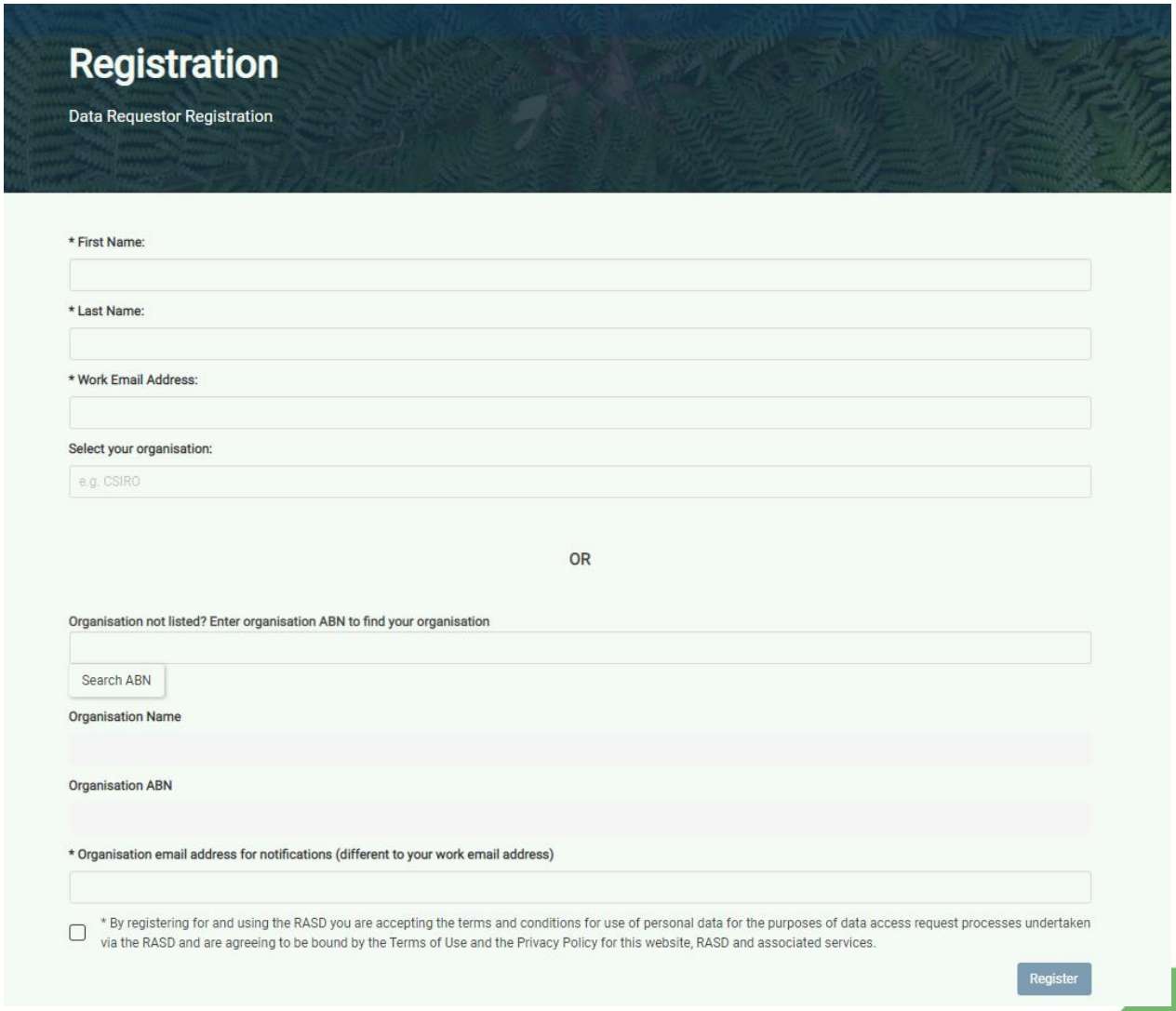
1.3 Register as a Data Requestor

If you wish to register as a Data Requestor, click on the “Register as a Data Requestor” button on the registration entry page (highlighted in orange below).



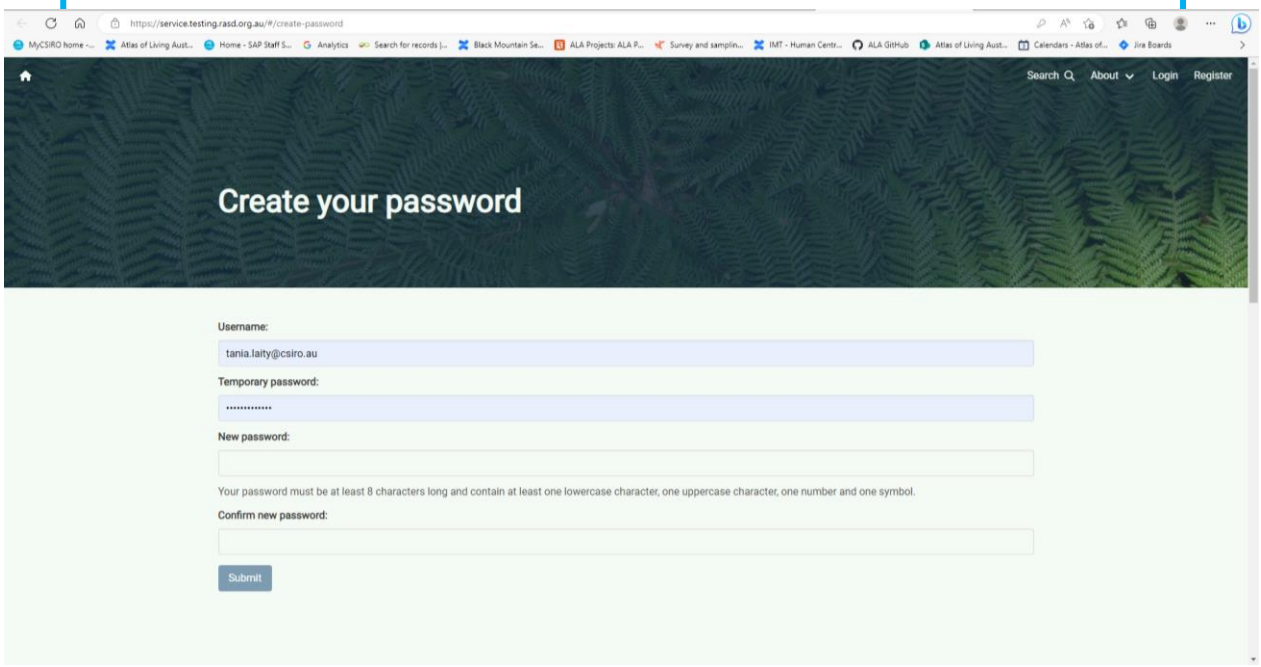
You will be taken to the Data Requestor Registration form (shown below). All fields marked with an asterisk (*) are mandatory. Enter your first and last name and your individual work email address.

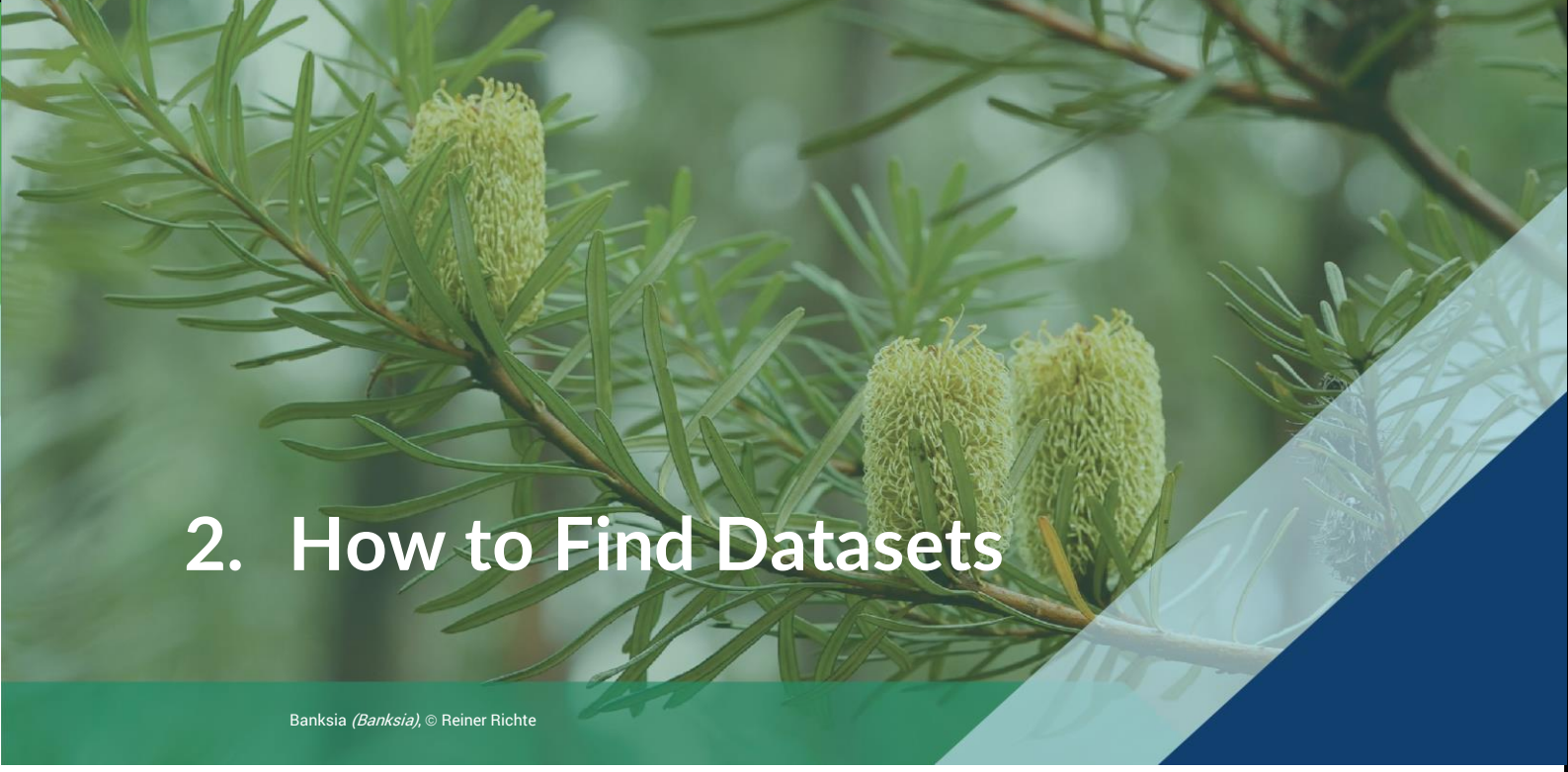
You are now required to either select your organisation from a list of already registered organisations or if your organisation is not listed, enter the ABN of your organisation. To check if your organisation is already registered or to select an already listed organisation, start typing in your organisation's name in the box highlighted in light blue below. If your organisation is already registered, select your organisation from the list. If your organisation is not registered, there will be no matches and you will have to add it using the ABN. If you do not know your organisation's ABN, you can look it up on the ABN Lookup website. Copy and paste your organisation's ABN exactly from the ABN Lookup website into the box highlighted orange on the screenshot below and click on the Search ABN button. The name and ABN of your organisation should automatically be filled in and your organisation added to the RASDS.



Click on the acceptance of terms and conditions check box to complete the form. You will have to click onto a blank area of the form and the Register button will become activated to enable you to submit the form (this will only happen if ALL mandatory fields have been completed.).

Once you have submitted your registration request, you will be redirected to the home page and you should see a message notifying you that your request has been received. The RASDS Administrators will review your request and either approve or decline it. If approved, you will receive an email with a temporary, one-time password to log in to the system. Click on the link in this email and you will be able to create a new permanent password (see screenshot below).



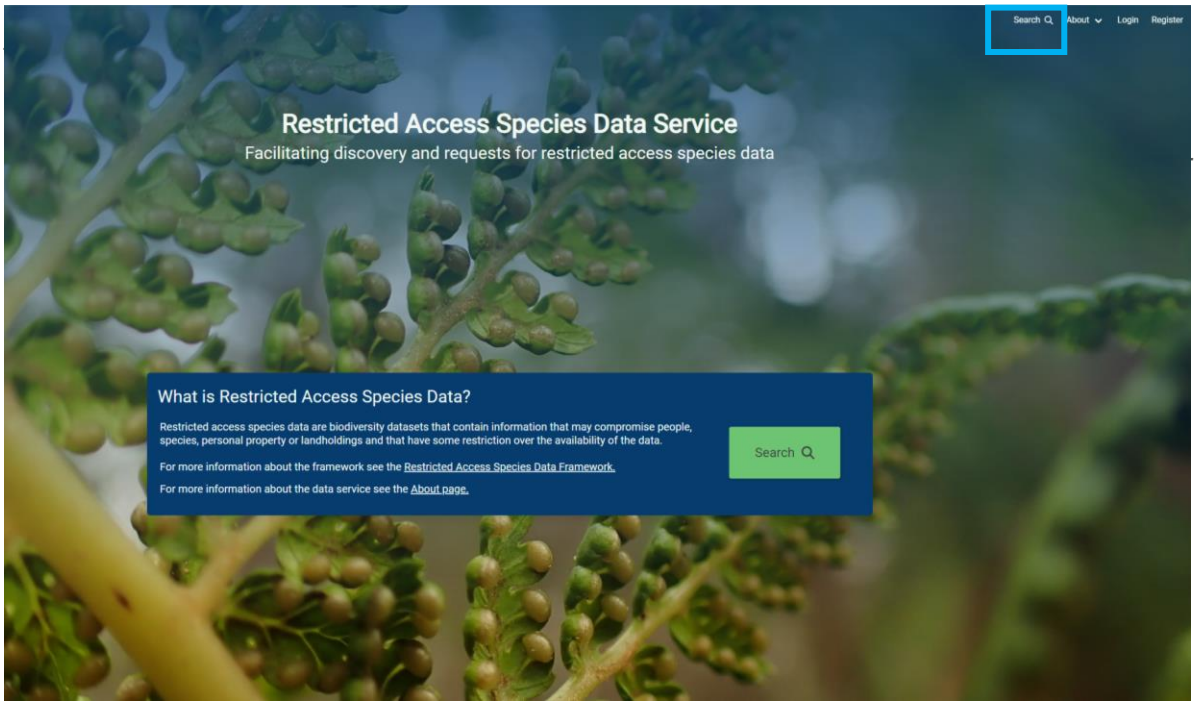


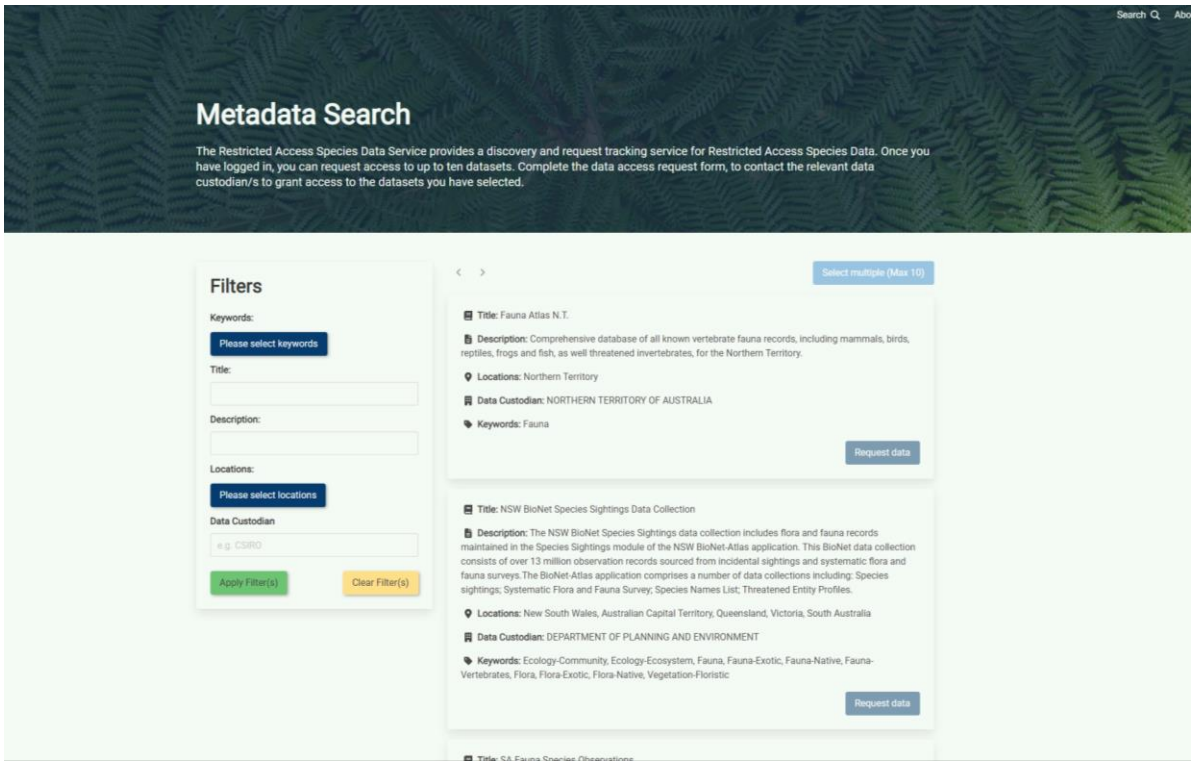
Banksia *(Banksia)*, © Reiner Richte

2. How to Find Datasets

To search metadata for RASD in the data service, either click on the green search button (see screenshot below) or the search button on the tool bar at the top of the home page RASD (see blue highlighted area in screenshot below).

Please note that not all datasets that are available have metadata in the RASD Service. If you the dataset you are looking for is not listed, but can there are records in the Atlas of Living Australia, please select the iNaturalist dataset and include all the datasets you are interested in in your request form.

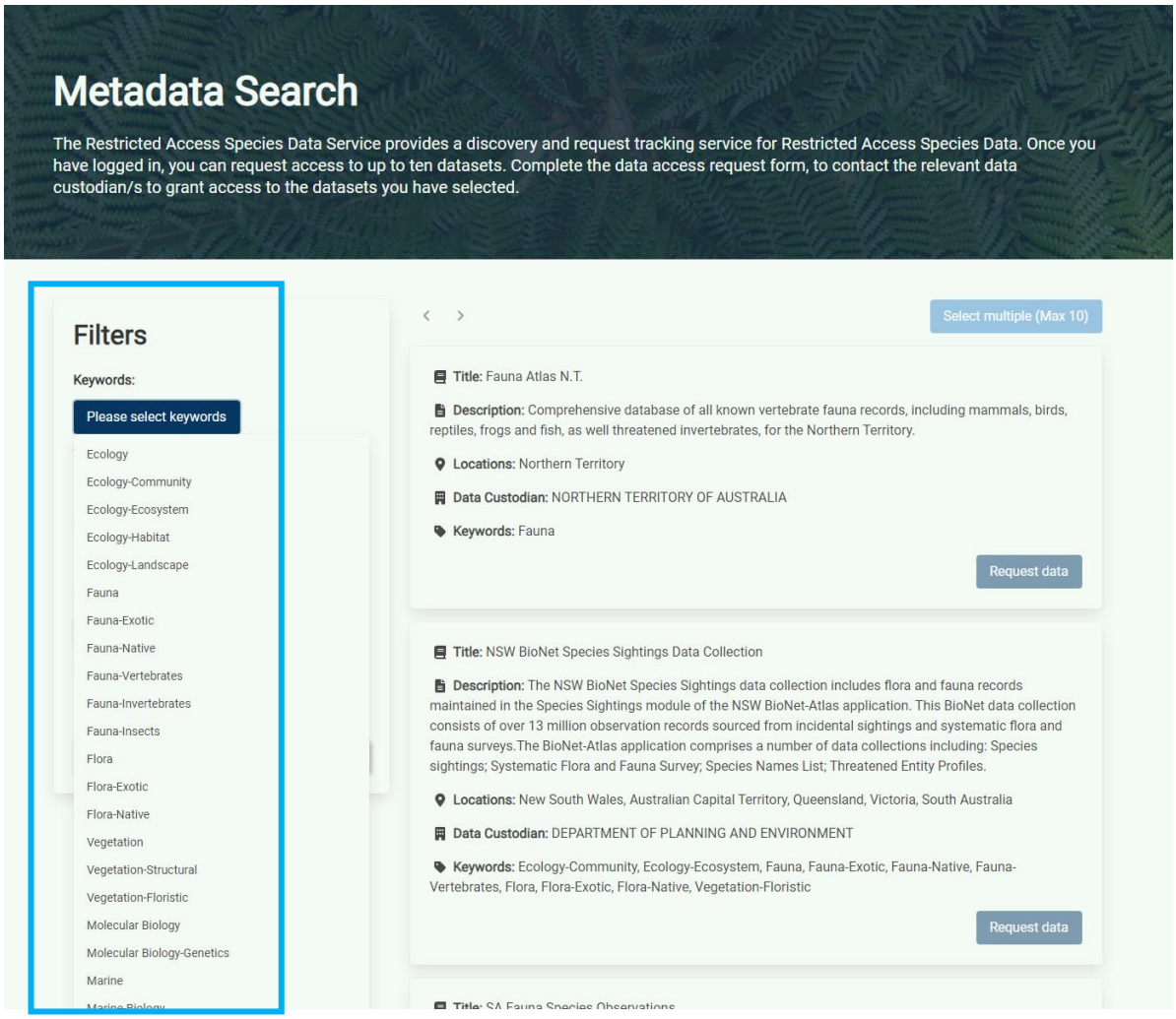




There are a number of ways you can search for metadata, including by keyword, by title or description, by coarse location or by data custodian. You can search by one of these or a combination. If at any time you wish to remove any filters / search criteria and browse the full list of metadata, click on the “Clear Filter(s)” Button (yellow button in screenshot above).

2.1 Searching by Keyword

To search the metadata by keyword, click on the “please select keywords” button on the metadata search page. A dropdown list of keywords will appear (see screenshot below).



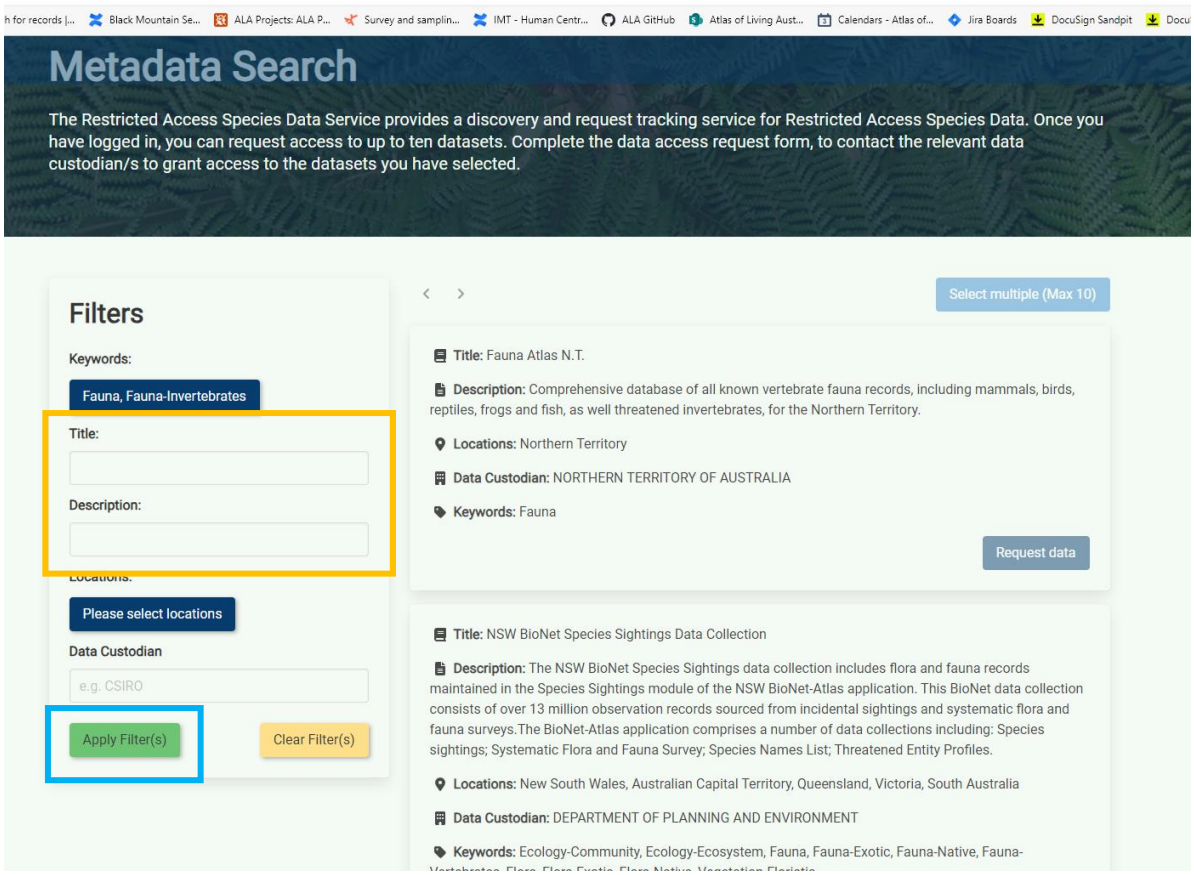
Select one or more keywords to filter the metadata. Once you have selected your keyword(s), click anywhere on the screen away from the dropdown list and then click on the “Apply Filter(s)” button (see button highlighted blue in the screenshot below).

A subset of the metadata which is tagged with your selected keywords will be displayed.

2.2 Searching by Title or Description

To filter by Title or Description, you can enter any free text in either of the Title or Description fields (highlighted in orange in the screenshot below).

Click on the “Apply Filter(s)” button (blue highlight in screenshot below) to select a subset of the metadata based on your search criteria.

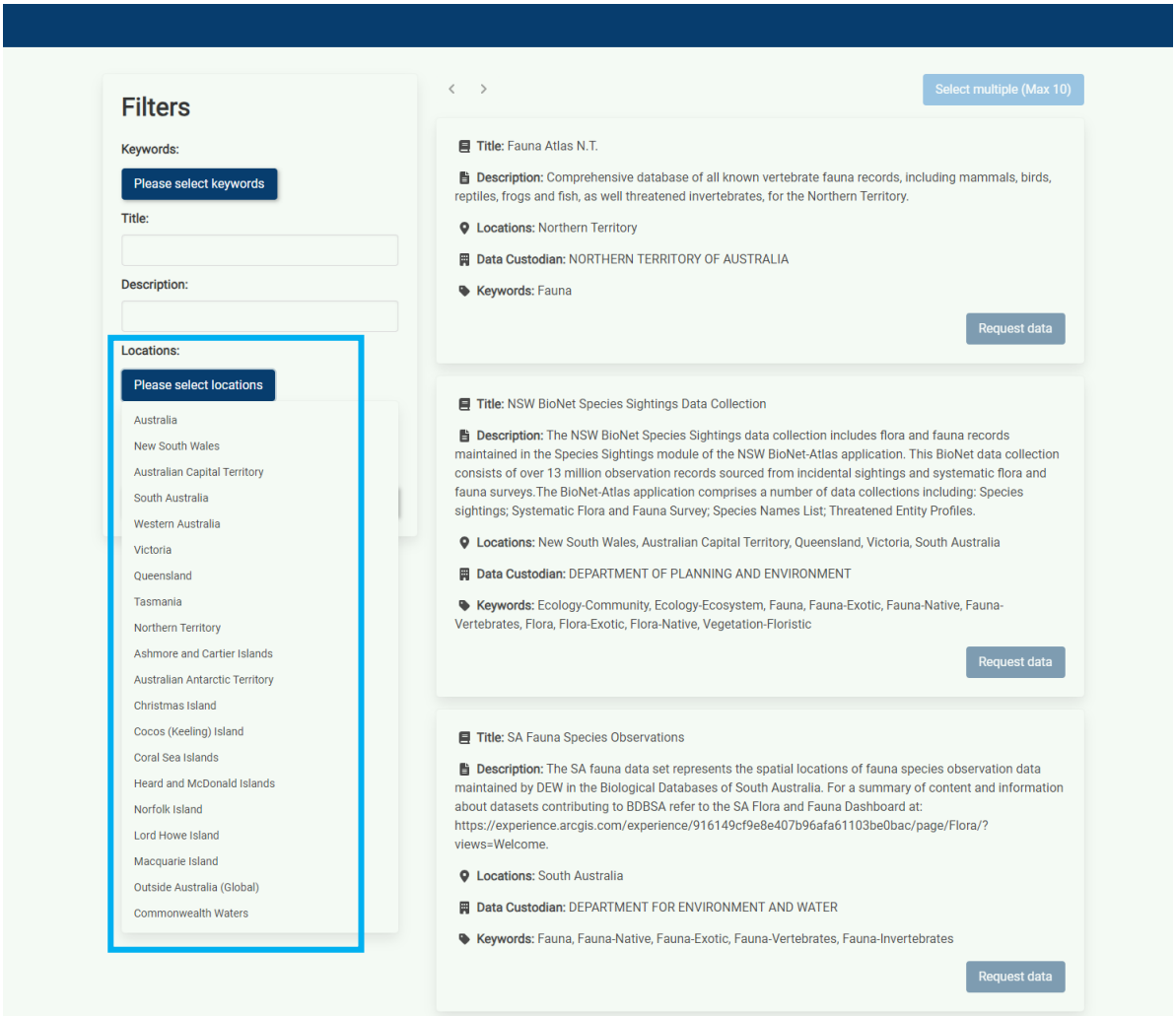


2.3 Searching by Location

To search the metadata by keyword, click on the “please select locations” button on the metadata search page. A dropdown list of coarse locations will appear (see screenshot below). Currently these are limited to Australian states and territories, islands and “Outside Australia (Global)”.

Select one or more locations to filter the metadata. Once you have selected your location(s), click anywhere on the screen away from the dropdown list and then click on the “Apply Filter(s)” button (see button highlighted blue in the screenshot below).

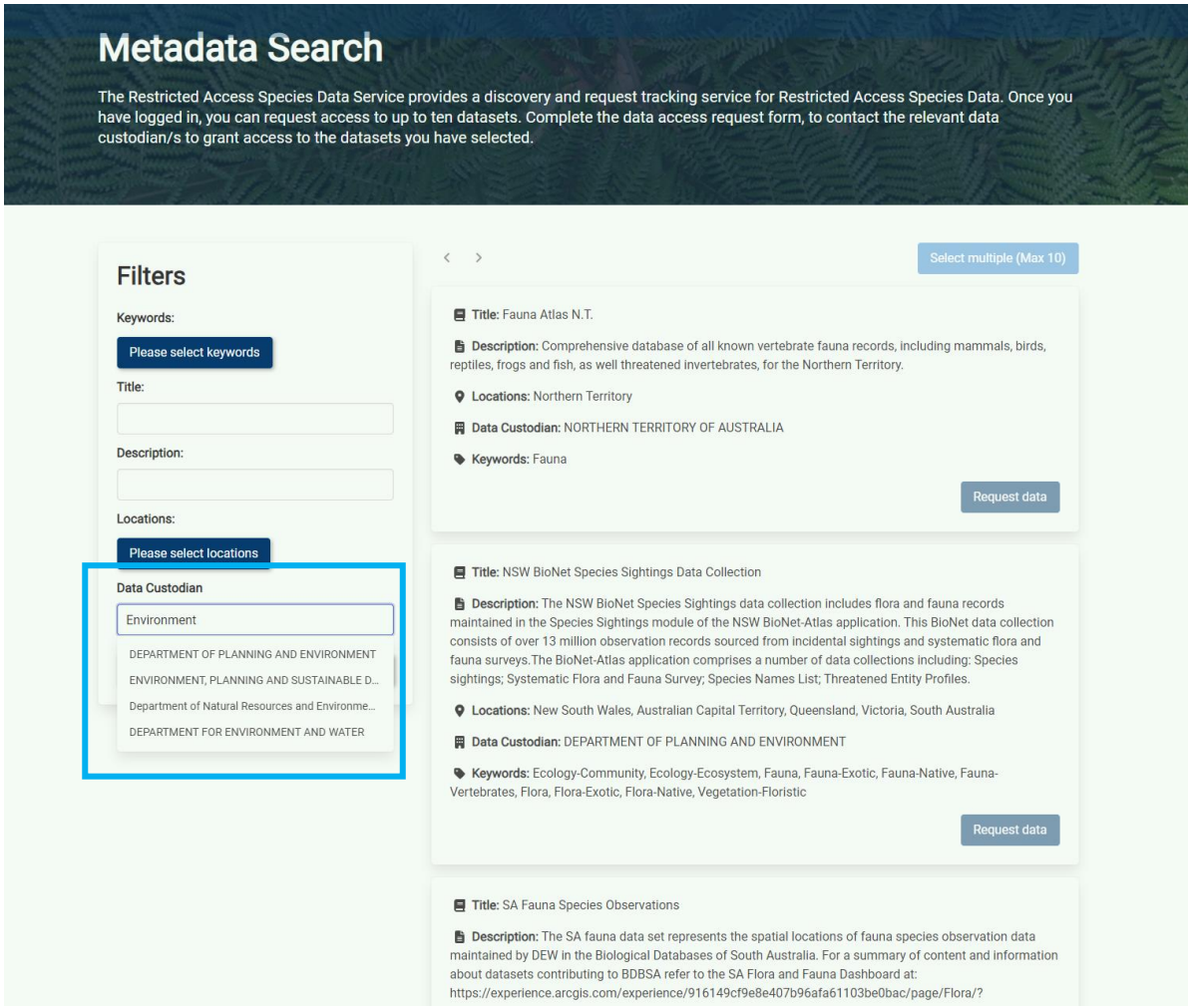
A subset of the metadata which is tagged with your selected locations will be displayed.



2.4 Searching by Data Custodian

To search the metadata by data custodian, start typing either the custodian's organisation or a word in the title of the organisation and a list of suggested organisations which meet your criteria will be displayed (see screenshot below). Select the custodian organisation which you wish to filter by and click on the "Apply Filter(s)" button.

A subset of the metadata from your selected custodian will be displayed.


Metadata Search
The Restricted Access Species Data Service provides a discovery and request tracking service for Restricted Access Species Data. Once you have logged in, you can request access to up to ten datasets. Complete the data access request form, to contact the relevant data custodian/s to grant access to the datasets you have selected.
Filters
Keywords:
Please select keywords
Title:
Description:
Locations:
Please select locations
Data Custodian
Environment
DEPARTMENT OF PLANNING AND ENVIRONMENT
ENVIRONMENT, PLANNING AND SUSTAINABLE D...
Department of Natural Resources and Environme...
DEPARTMENT FOR ENVIRONMENT AND WATER
Select multiple (Max 10)
Title: Fauna Atlas N.T.
Description: Comprehensive database of all known vertebrate fauna records, including mammals, birds, reptiles, frogs and fish, as well threatened invertebrates, for the Northern Territory.
Locations: Northern Territory
Data Custodian: NORTHERN TERRITORY OF AUSTRALIA
Keywords: Fauna
Request data
Title: NSW BioNet Species Sightings Data Collection
Description: The NSW BioNet Species Sightings data collection includes flora and fauna records maintained in the Species Sightings module of the NSW BioNet-Atlas application. This BioNet data collection consists of over 13 million observation records sourced from incidental sightings and systematic flora and fauna surveys.The BioNet-Atlas application comprises a number of data collections including: Species sightings; Systematic Flora and Fauna Survey; Species Names List; Threatened Entity Profiles.
Locations: New South Wales, Australian Capital Territory, Queensland, Victoria, South Australia
Data Custodian: DEPARTMENT OF PLANNING AND ENVIRONMENT
Keywords: Ecology-Community, Ecology-Ecosystem, Fauna, Fauna-Exotic, Fauna-Native, Fauna-Vertebrates, Flora, Flora-Exotic, Flora-Native, Vegetation-Floristic
Request data
Title: SA Fauna Species Observations
Description: The SA fauna data set represents the spatial locations of fauna species observation data maintained by DEW in the Biological Databases of South Australia. For a summary of content and information about datasets contributing to BDBSA refer to the SA Flora and Fauna Dashboard at: https://experience.arcgis.com/experience/916149cf9e8e407b96afa61103be0bac/page/Flora/?



Fungus *(Cruentomycena viscidocruenta)*, © Reiner Richte

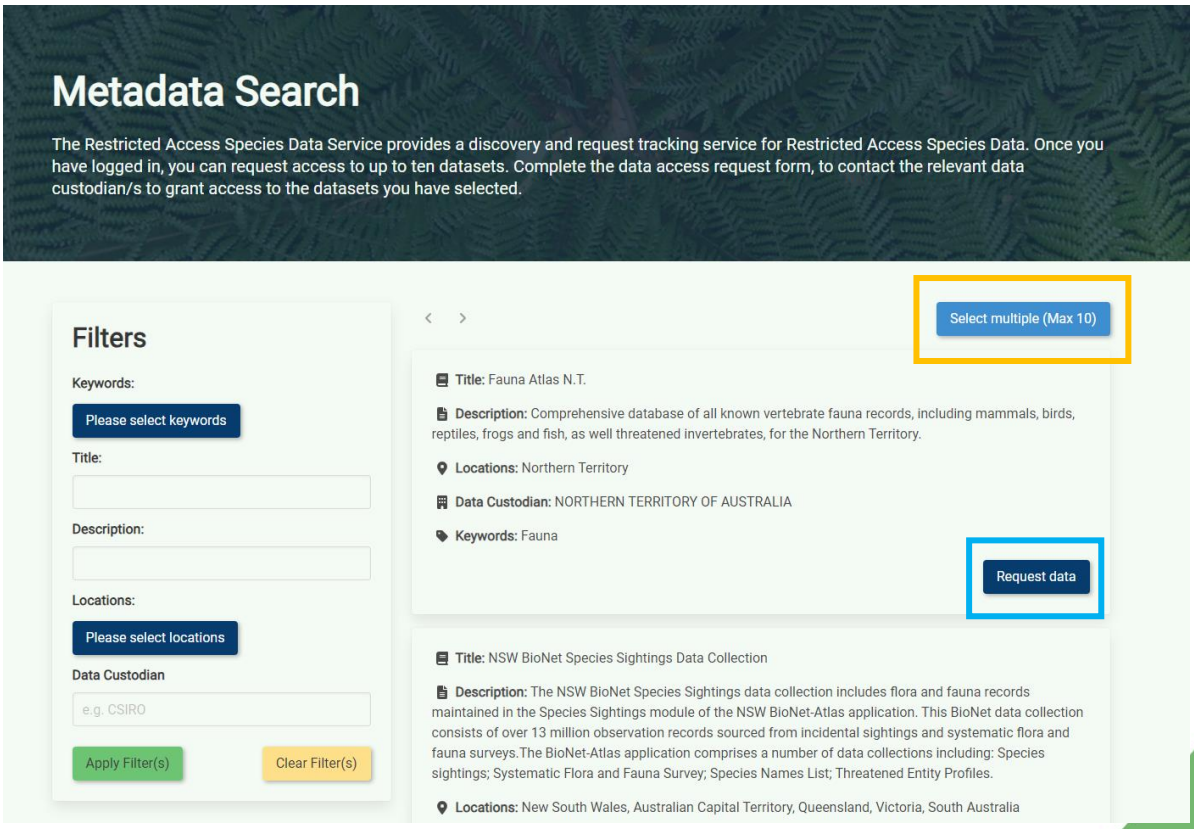
3. How to Request Data
(Data Requestor Role Only)

To request data via the RASDS you need to be registered as a data requestor and be logged into the portal.

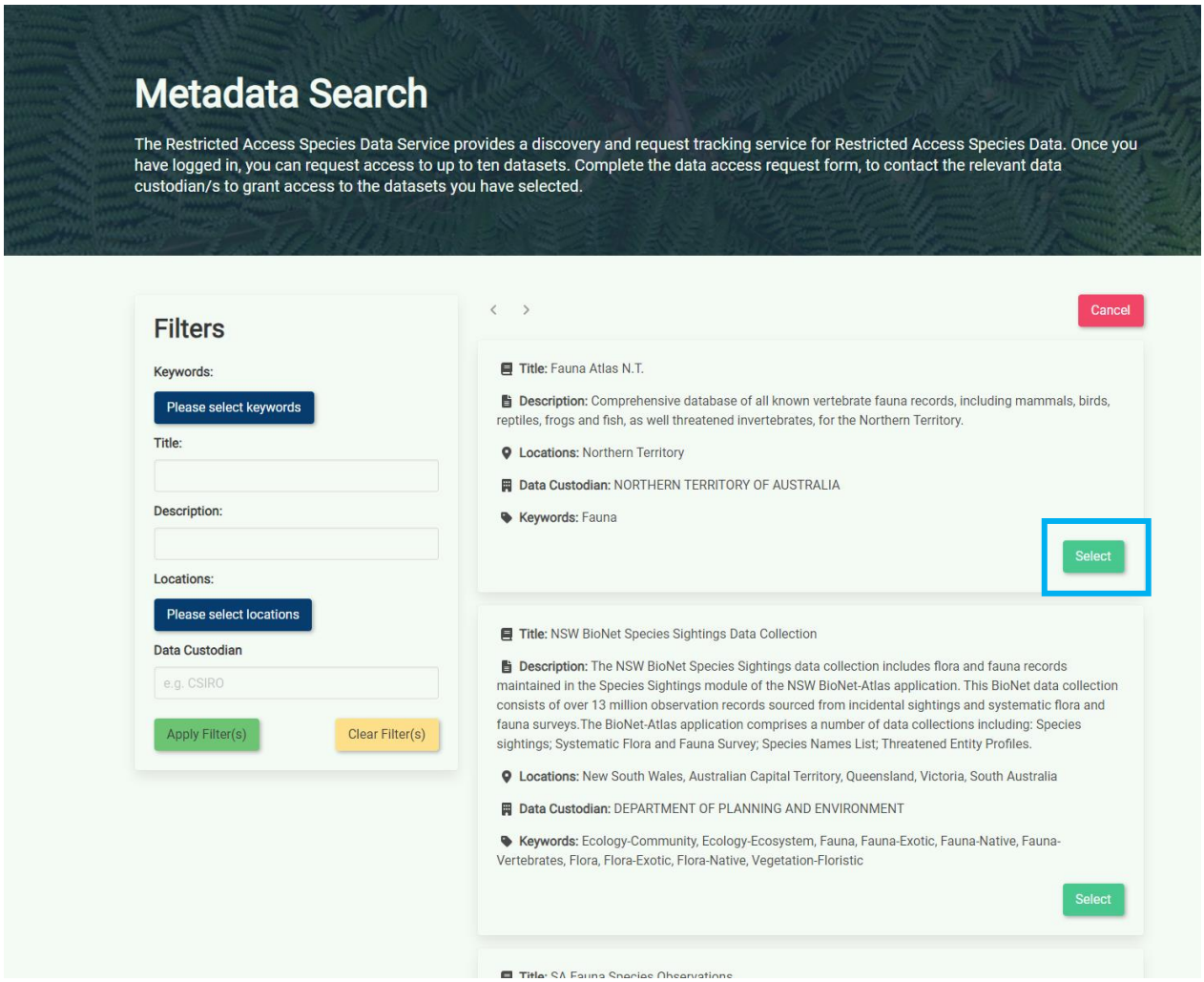
3.1 Selecting data to request

Once you are logged into the portal, follow the guidance on how to search for data in Section 2 above. You can also access the search function, once logged in through you Tools via this link - https://service.rasd.org.au/#/tools.

If you are only wanting to select one dataset, simply click on the “request data” button associated with the datasets metadata on the search page – see blue highlight in screenshot below.

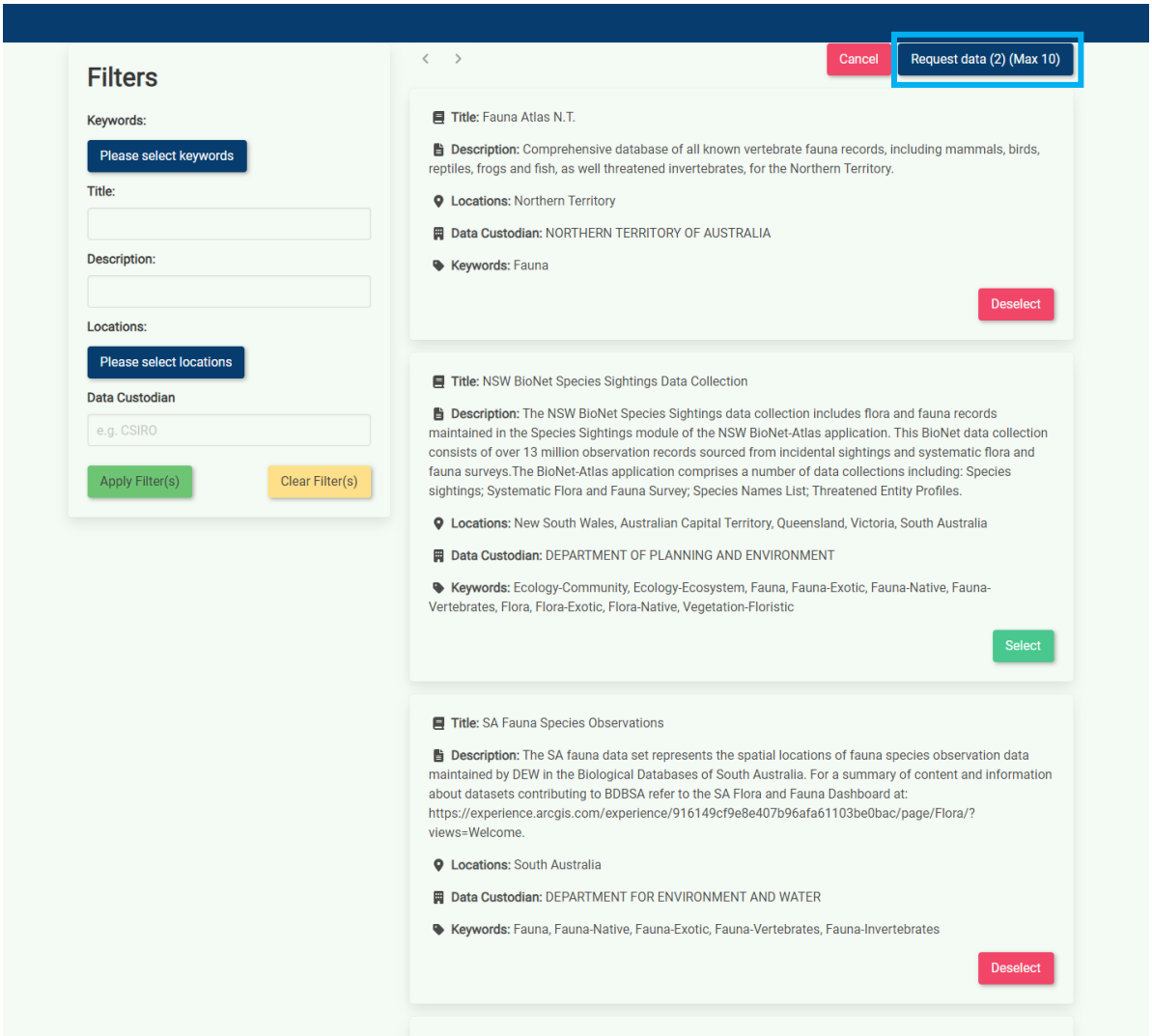


If you would like to request more than one dataset, click on the “Select Multiple” button – highlighted in orange in the screenshot above. This will then transform the “Request Data” buttons on each metadata statement to “Select” buttons (see blue highlight in screenshot below). You can now select up to 10 datasets by selecting each individual metadata statement.



Once you select a dataset using the select buttons, these buttons change from green to red and the text changes from select to deselect. In addition, a “Request data” button appears above the metadata – see blue highlight in the screenshot below.

Once you have selected all the datasets you’d like to request, click on the “Request data” button to open the data request form.

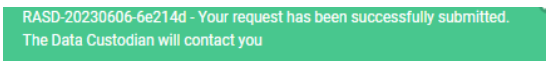


3.2 The data request form

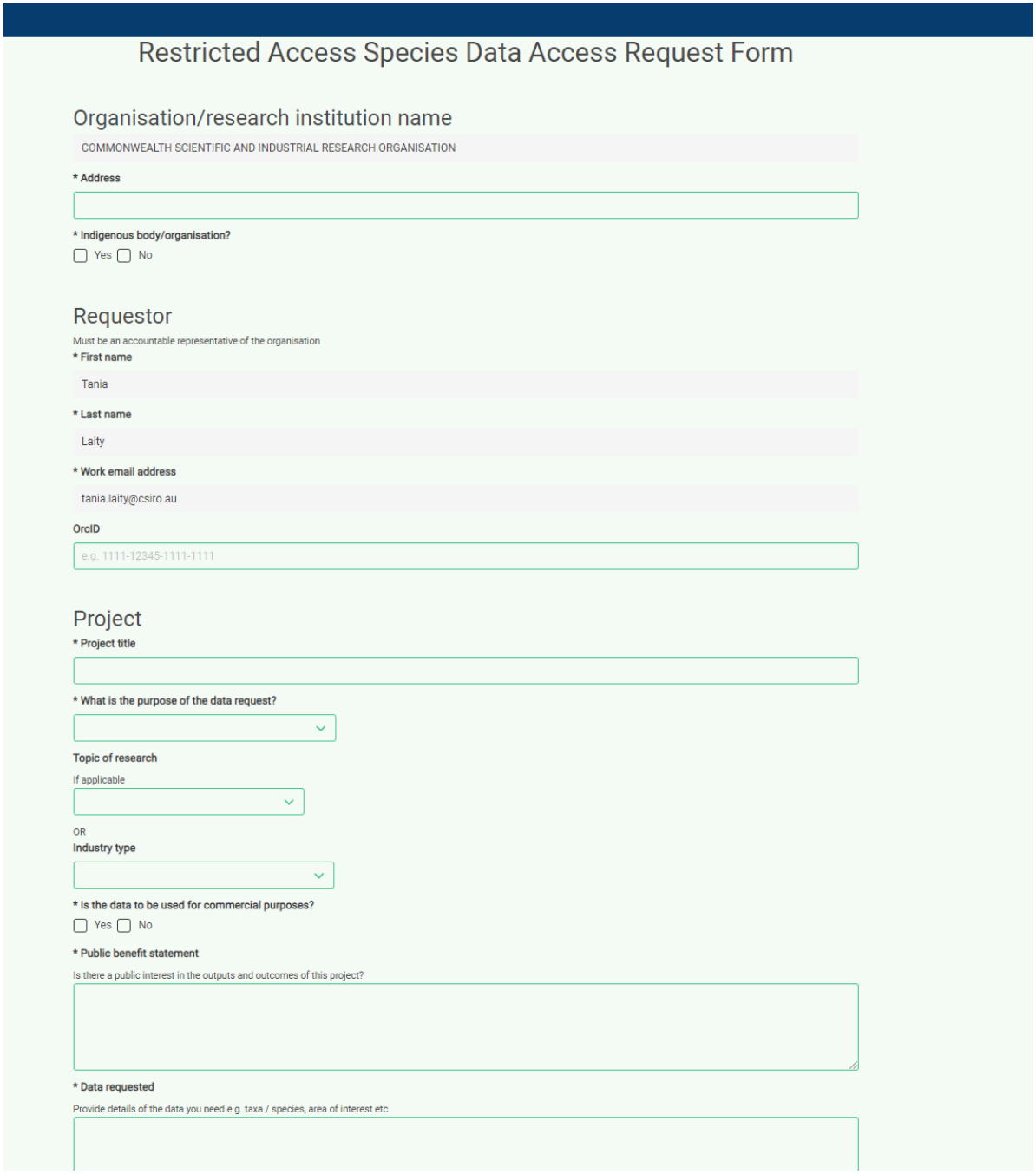
The data access request for will be automatically populated with your organisation name, your first and last names and your work email address. All fields that are marked with an asterisk are mandatory and need to be completed prior to submitting the form (see screenshot below).

You will notice, when filling out the form, that some of the text boxes are greyed out. You will be able to enter information in these if the preceding question requires it. For example if you select the “defined period” check box under the question “How often do you require this data” you will then be able to enter “Date Required from” and “Date Required to” into the relevant text boxes.

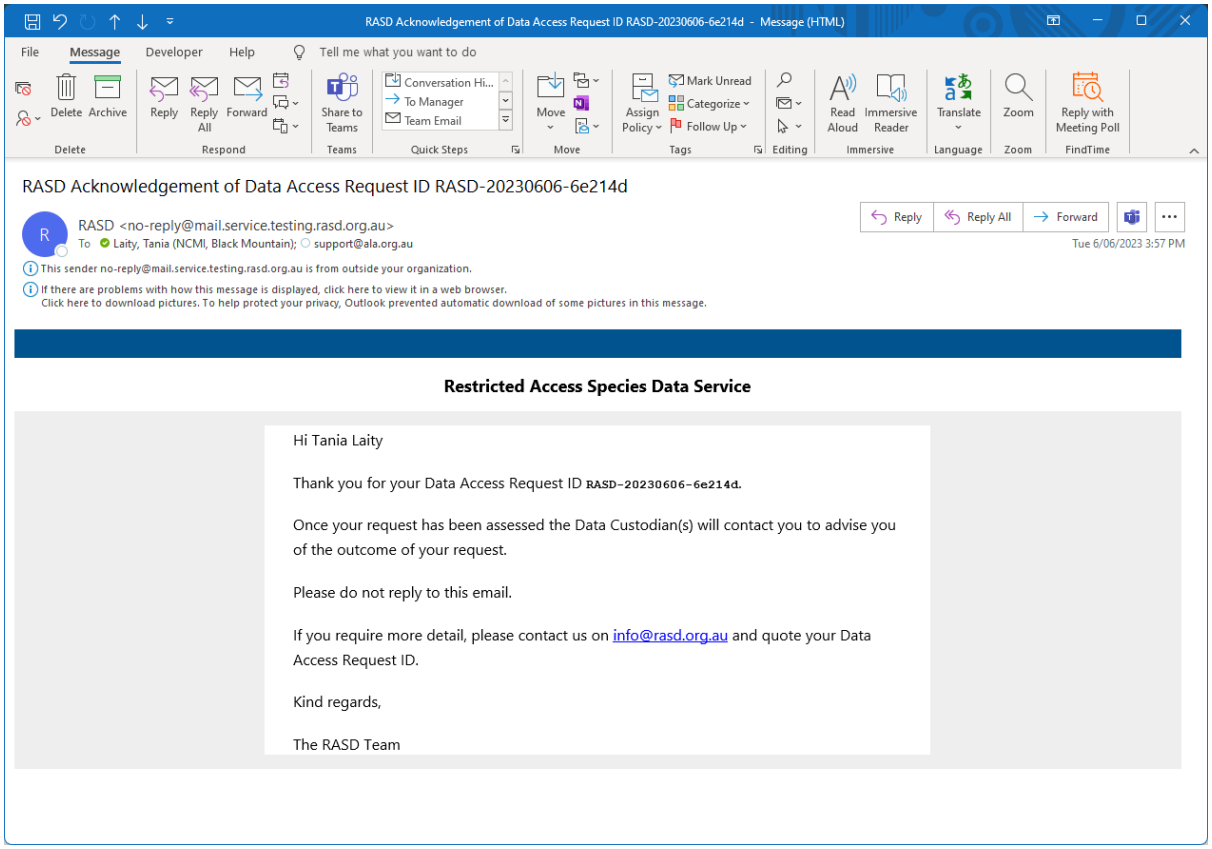
Once you have completed all mandatory fields and clicked on the submit button at the bottom of the form, you will be

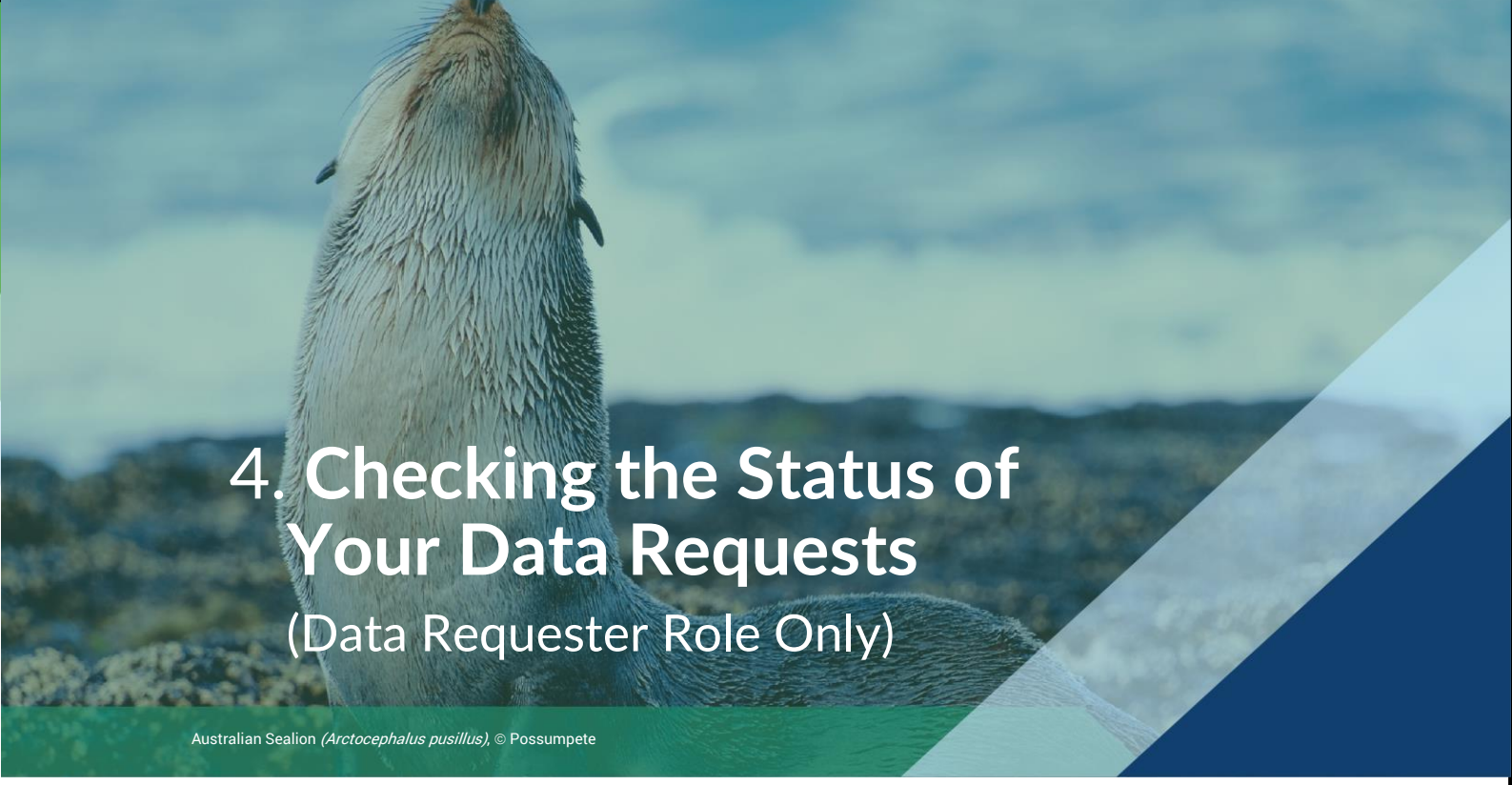


redirected back to the search page and you should receive a pop up message similar to this:



Once your request has been submitted, a notification email will be sent to all data custodians to which the request pertains. You should also get an acknowledgement email notifying you that your request has been received (similar to that in the screen shot below)


RASD Acknowledgement of Data Access Request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d - Message (HTML)
File
Message
Developer
Help
Tell me what you want to do
Delete
Archive
Reply
Reply All
Forward
Share to Teams
Conversation Hi...
To Manager
Team Email
Move
Assign Policy
Mark Unread
Categorize
Follow Up
Read Aloud
Immersive Reader
Translate
Zoom
Reply with Meeting Poll
Delete
Respond
Teams
Quick Steps
Move
Tags
Editing
Immersive
Language
Zoom
FindTime
RASD Acknowledgement of Data Access Request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d
RASD <no-reply@mail.service.testing.rasd.org.au>
To Laity, Tania (NCMI, Black Mountain); support@ala.org.au
Reply
Reply All
Forward
Tue 6/06/2023 3:57 PM
This sender no-reply@mail.service.testing.rasd.org.au is from outside your organization.
If there are problems with how this message is displayed, click here to view it in a web browser.
Click here to download pictures. To help protect your privacy, Outlook prevented automatic download of some pictures in this message.
Restricted Access Species Data Service
Hi Tania Laity
Thank you for your Data Access Request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d.
Once your request has been assessed the Data Custodian(s) will contact you to advise you of the outcome of your request.
Please do not reply to this email.
If you require more detail, please contact us on info@rasd.org.au and quote your Data Access Request ID.
Kind regards,
The RASD Team

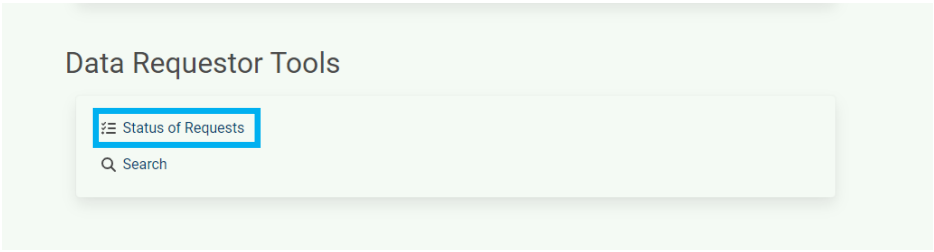


Australian Sealion *(Arctocephalus pusillus)*, © Possumpete

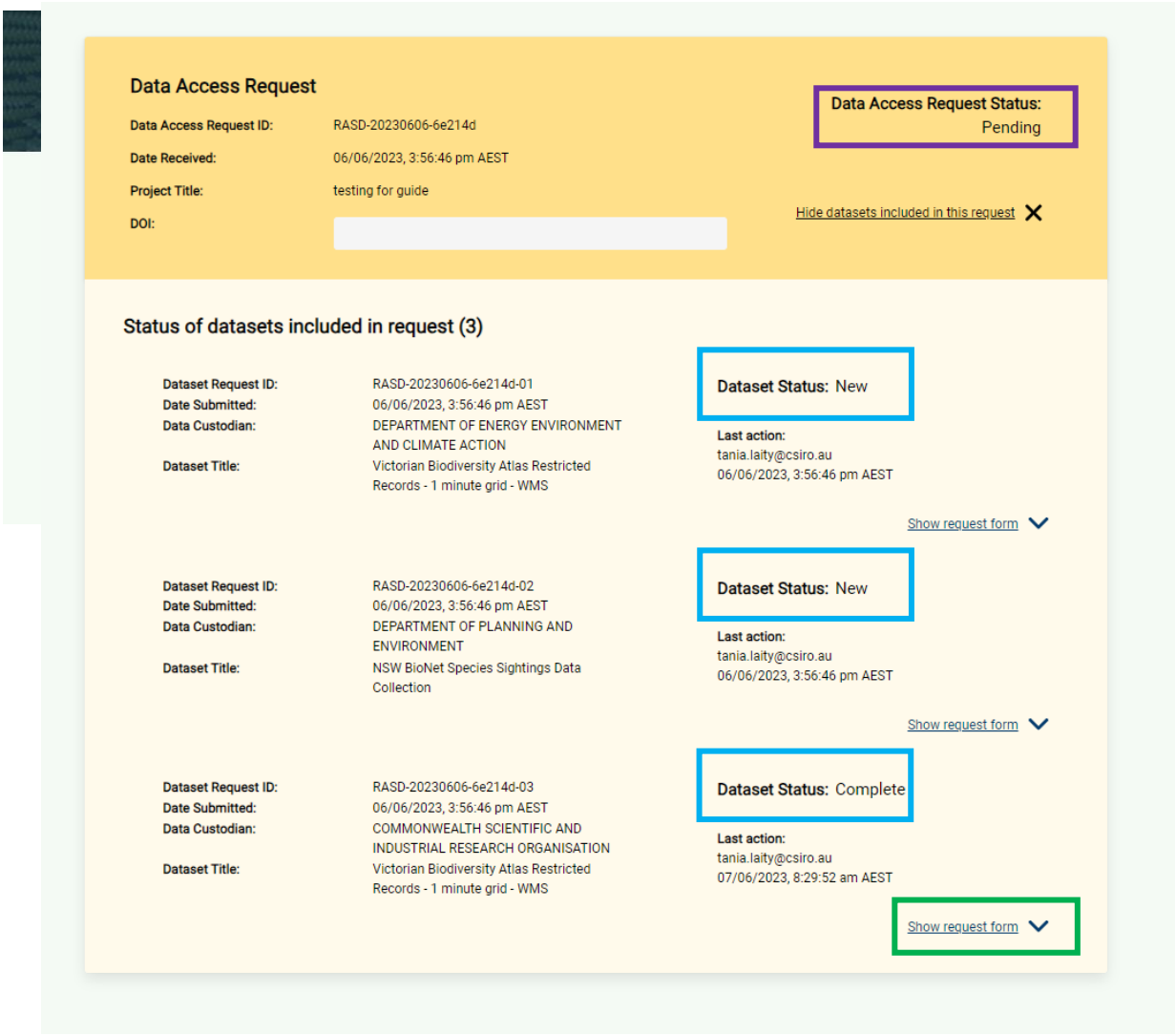
4. Checking the Status of Your Data Requests

(Data Requester Role Only)

Once you have submitted a request for data, you can track the status of your request by logging into the portal and clicking on the “Status of Requests” link under your tools (see screenshot below).



You will then be taken to a compacted list of any data requests you may have made (whether complete, pending or declined). The screenshot below shows an example of a request. You can see the status of the overall request as shown in the top right (blue highlighted area). Other important summary details about your request are shown in this view including the date of the request and the request ID (purple highlighted area). You can see a list of the datasets you’ve requested by clicking on the down arrow next to the “Show datasets included in this request” link (green highlighted area). Clicking on this link will expand the view and show you each individual dataset included in your request and the approval status of each (see screenshot on next page).



You can see from the above screenshot that 3 datasets were included in the request and the details of each including the status of requests. As this request included data from 3 separate data custodians, each dataset will be assessed separately by them. The blue highlighted areas show the status of each individual dataset request. The status of the parent request (purple highlight in above screenshot) will remain pending until all the child request statuses are marked as complete. A status of new means that it has been sent to the data custodian but hasn't been actioned.

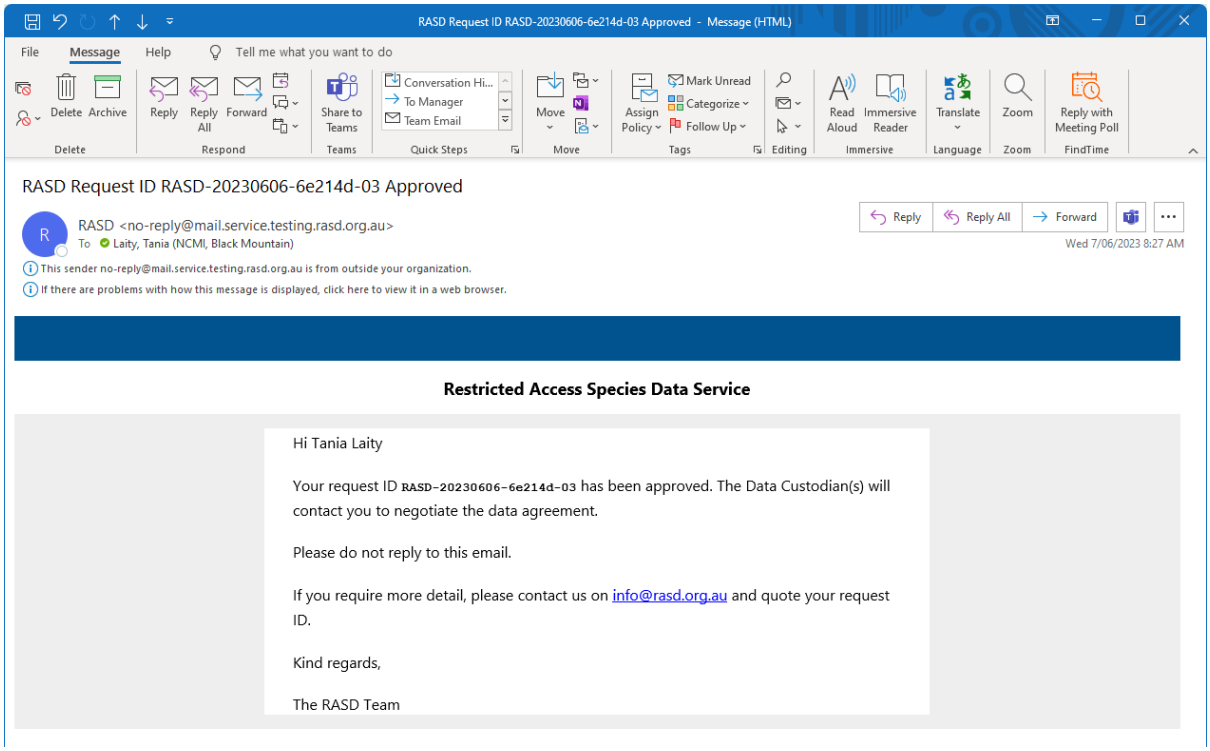
If at any time you wish to see the completed request form for the request, click on the "Show request form" link (highlighted green above).

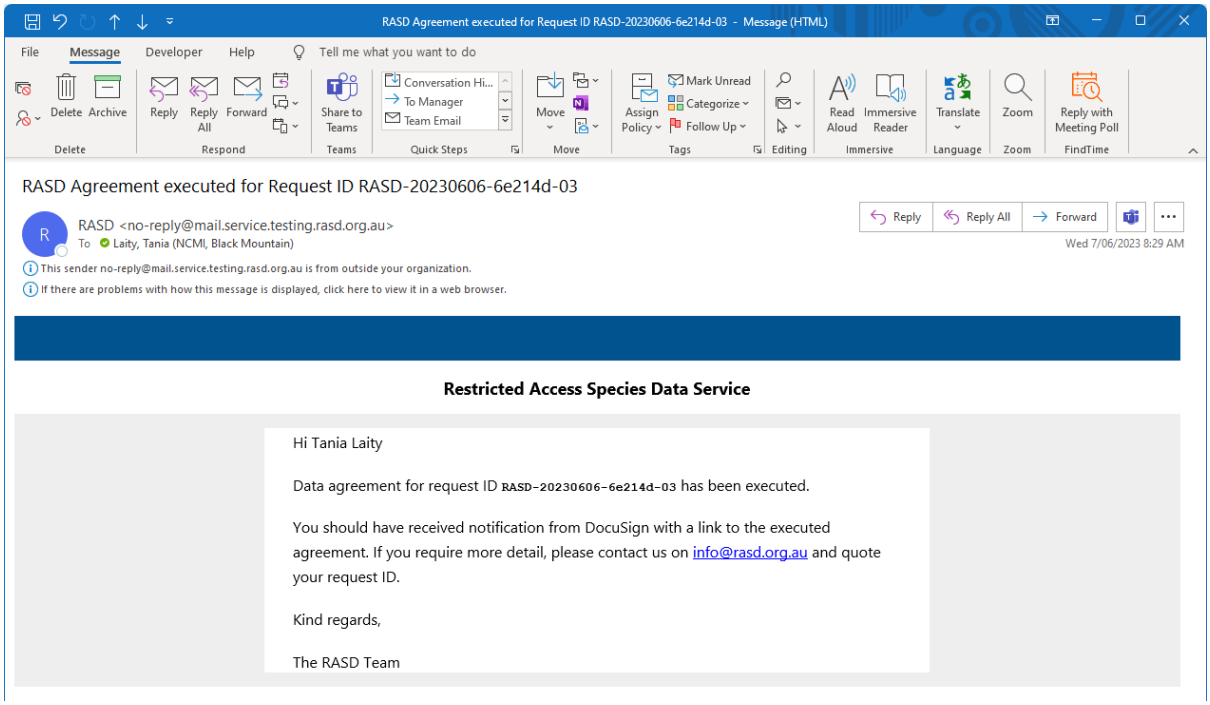
The approval process for each child dataset is as follows:

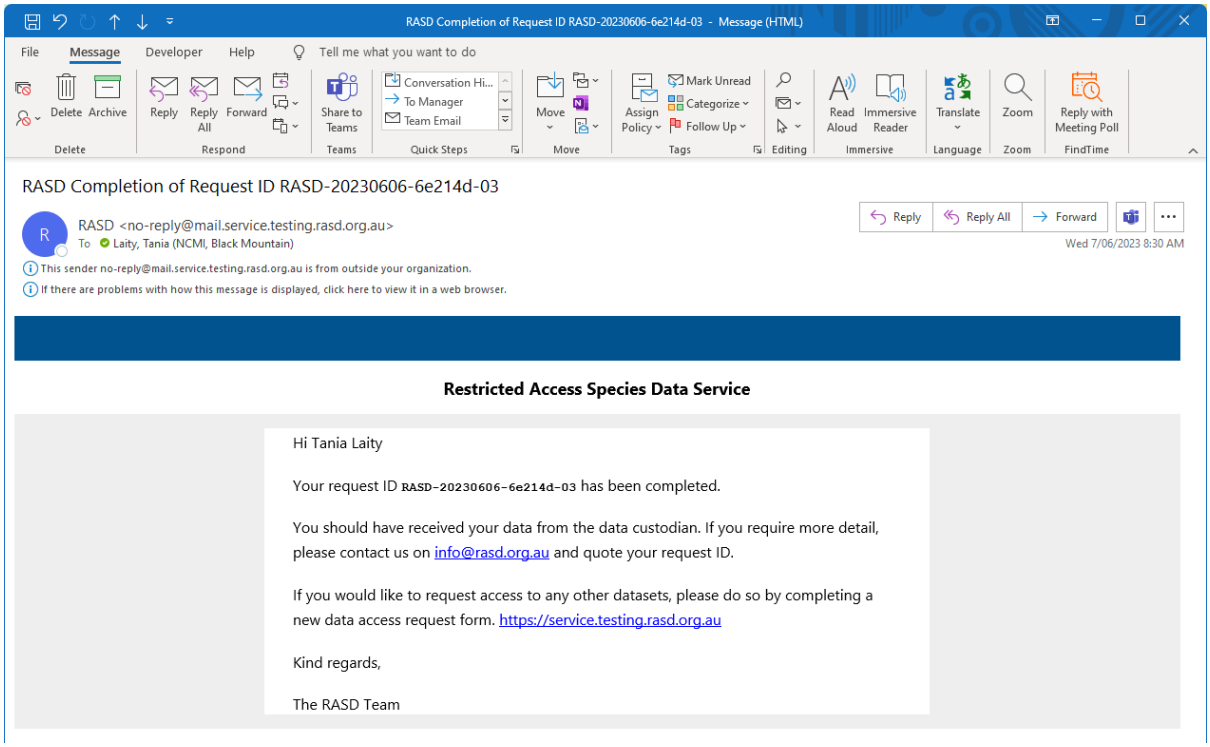
- Data custodian assesses request and either approves of declines
- If approved, you will get an email (see below) notifying you that the data custodian will be in touch to negotiate a data agreement (legal agreement)

- You will be sent a final copy of the data agreement for signing securely via DocuSign
- Once a data agreement has been signed by both parties, the status for that individual dataset will be marked complete and the data custodian will send you the data.
- Only when all datasets within the request have been assessed and actioned will the Parent Data Access Request be marked as complete.

Examples of the notification emails at various steps of the process are shown below.




RASD Agreement executed for Request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d-03 - Message (HTML)
File Message Developer Help Tell me what you want to do
Delete Archive Reply Reply All Forward Share to Teams Move Assign Policy Mark Unread Categorize Follow Up Read Aloud Immersive Reader Translate Zoom Reply with Meeting Poll
RASD Agreement executed for Request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d-03
RASD <no-reply@mail.service.testing.rasd.org.au>
To Laity, Tania (NCMI, Black Mountain)
Reply Reply All Forward
Wed 7/06/2023 8:29 AM
This sender no-reply@mail.service.testing.rasd.org.au is from outside your organization.
If there are problems with how this message is displayed, click here to view it in a web browser.
Restricted Access Species Data Service
Hi Tania Laity
Data agreement for request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d-03 has been executed.
You should have received notification from DocuSign with a link to the executed agreement. If you require more detail, please contact us on info@rasd.org.au and quote your request ID.
Kind regards,
The RASD Team


RASD Completion of Request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d-03 - Message (HTML)
File Message Developer Help Tell me what you want to do
Delete Archive Reply Reply All Forward Share to Teams Move Assign Policy Mark Unread Categorize Follow Up Read Aloud Immersive Reader Translate Zoom Reply with Meeting Poll
RASD Completion of Request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d-03
RASD <no-reply@mail.service.testing.rasd.org.au>
To Laity, Tania (NCMI, Black Mountain)
Reply Reply All Forward
Wed 7/06/2023 8:30 AM
This sender no-reply@mail.service.testing.rasd.org.au is from outside your organization.
If there are problems with how this message is displayed, click here to view it in a web browser.
Restricted Access Species Data Service
Hi Tania Laity
Your request ID RASD-20230606-6e214d-03 has been completed.
You should have received your data from the data custodian. If you require more detail, please contact us on info@rasd.org.au and quote your request ID.
If you would like to request access to any other datasets, please do so by completing a new data access request form. https://service.testing.rasd.org.au
Kind regards,
The RASD Team

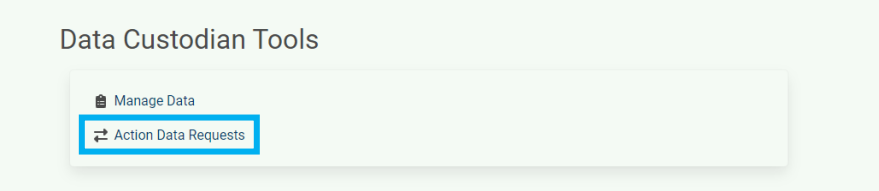


Australian Pelican *(Pelecanus conspicullatus)*, © Deborod

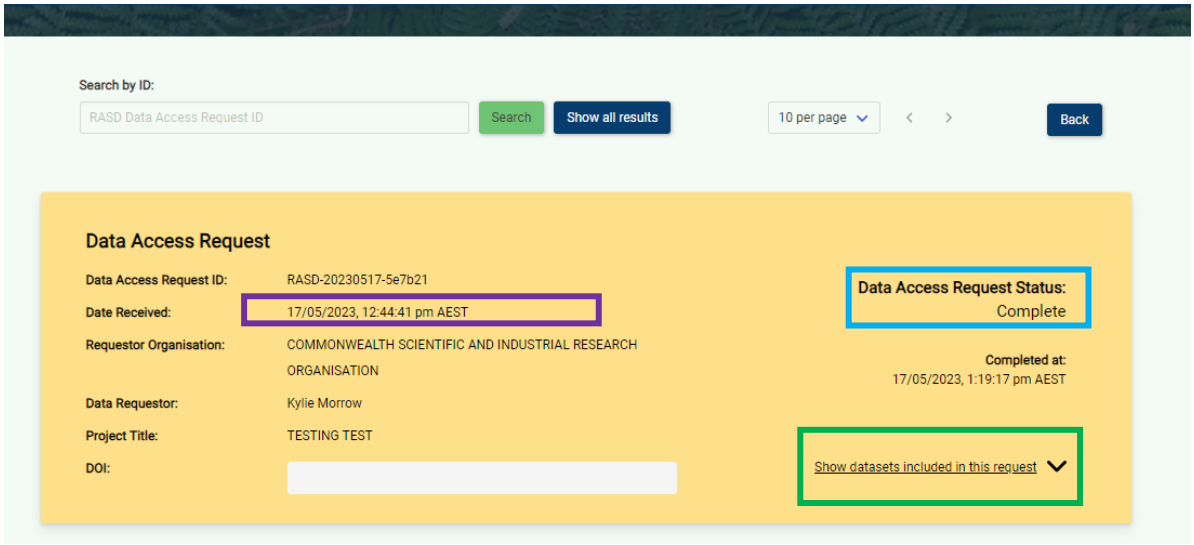
5. How to Process Data Requests

(Data Custodians Only)

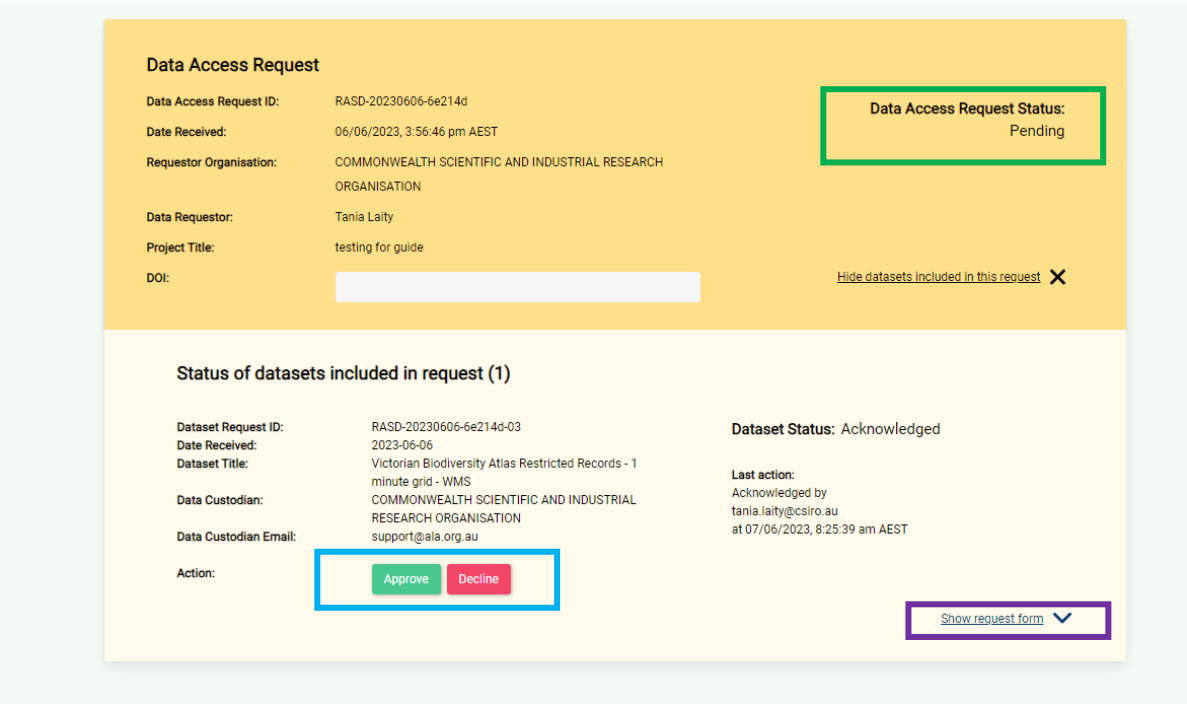
Once a data requestor submits a request for one of your datasets, you can track the status of the request by logging into the portal and clicking on the “Action Data Requests” link under your tools (see screenshot below).



You will then be taken to a compacted list of any data requests which may have been made for your data (whether complete, pending or declined). The screenshot below shows an example of a set of requests. You can see the status of an overall request as shown in the top right (blue highlighted area). Other important summary details about your requests are shown in this view including the date of the request and the request ID (purple highlighted area). You can see a list of your datasets which are included in the request by clicking on the down arrow next to the “Show datasets included in this request” link (green highlighted area). Clicking on this link will expand the view and show you each individual dataset included in the request and the approval status of each (see screenshot on next page).



The first step you will need to undertake, will be to acknowledge the request, by clicking on the acknowledge button. This will trigger a notification email to the data requestor stating that their request has been acknowledged. The next step is for you to review the data request and either approve or decline it (using the buttons highlighted in blue in the screenshot below).



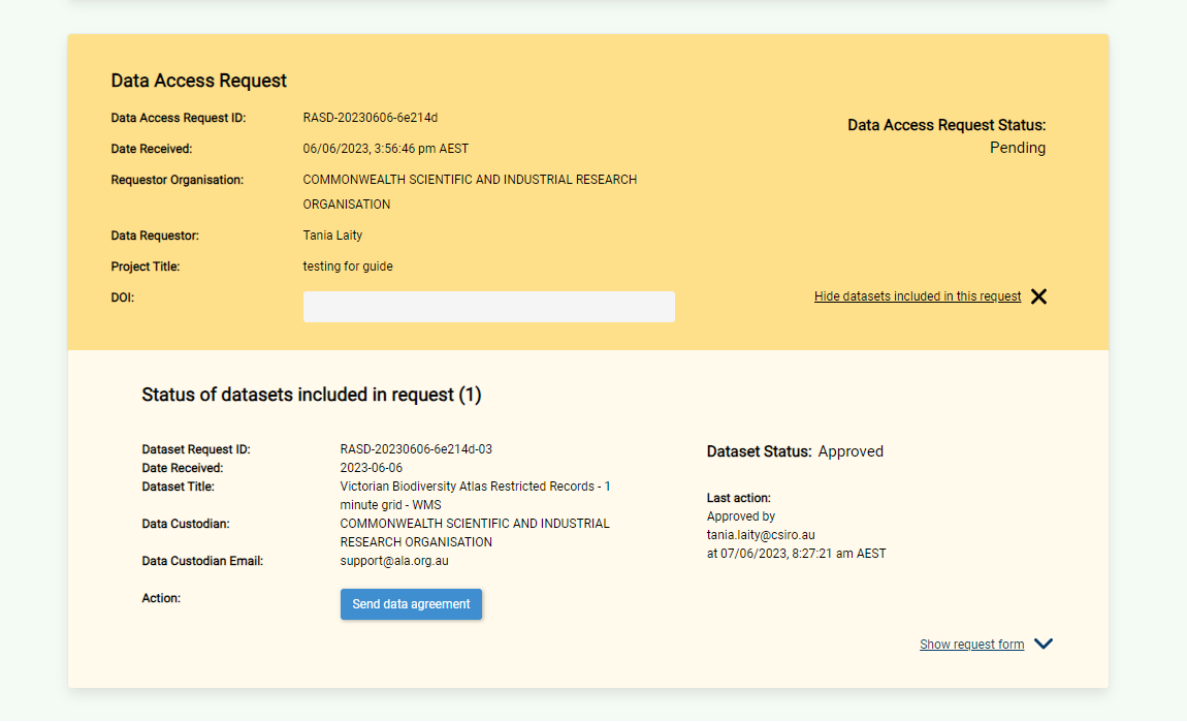
The Data Access Request Status (highlighted in green above) is the status of the overall request. This will only display as completed once the status of all child datasets within a request have been actioned as complete.

NOTE: If there are other child datasets included in the request that you are not the custodian for, you cannot view the status of these.

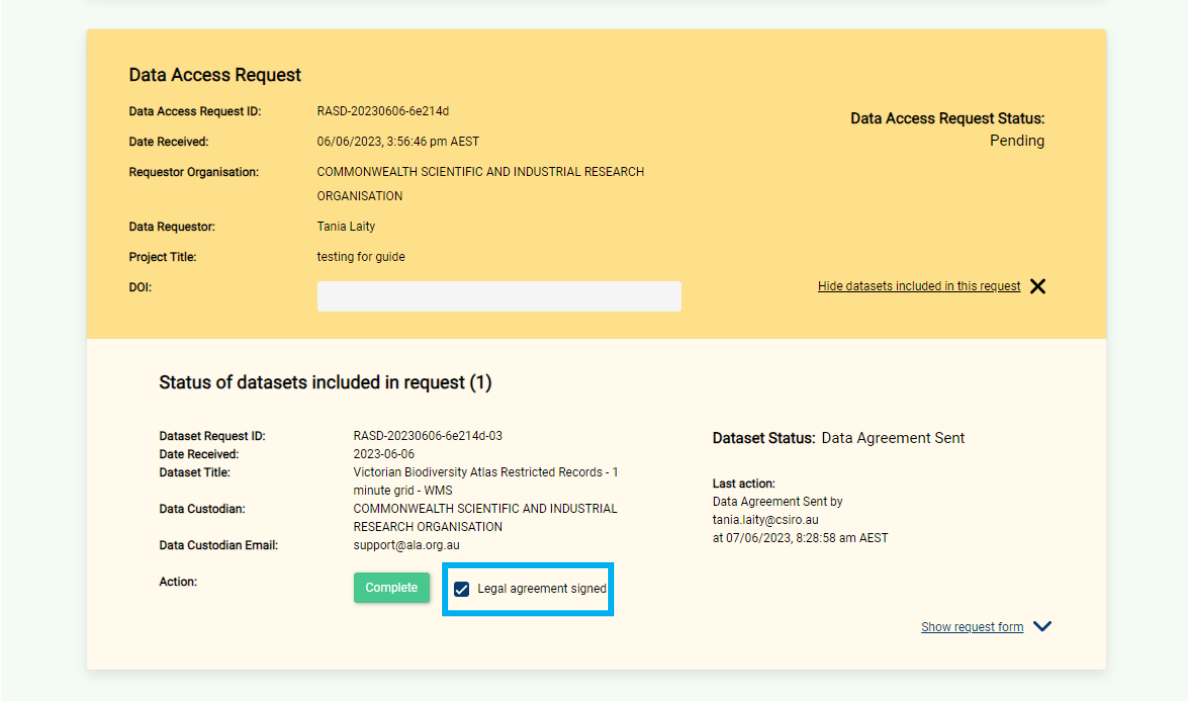
To view the details of the data request, including all information provided on the request form by the data requestor, click on dropdown arrow adjacent to the “Show request form” link (purple highlighted area in the screenshot above).

This will expand the data request form, to enable you to review the detailed information and make an informed decision as to whether you approve or decline the request for your data. If you decide to approve the request, a notification email will be sent to the data requestor and you can then start negotiations for a data agreement (legal agreement). Once you have a final version of the data agreement ready for signature, email RASDS admins on info@rasd.org.au to upload it into DocuSign to start the secure signature process.

Once the legal agreement is entered into DocuSign, it will be work flowed to the data requestor for signature and, once signed, to you for signing. Click on the Send data Agreement on the form below to update the status of the data request in RASDS.



Once you have received the signed copy and countersigned the legal agreement, click the checkbox on the screenshot below (blue highlight). You can now send the data to the requestor. Once this has been done, click on the green “complete” button on the screenshot below. The status of the dataset will be updated to Complete.



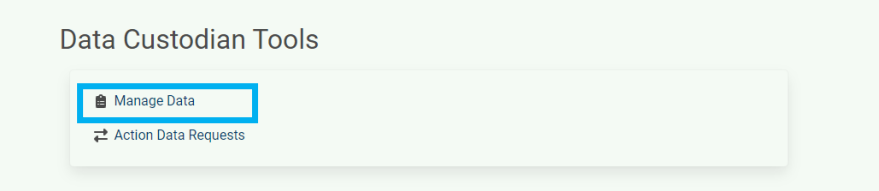


Bare nosed wombat *(Vombatus ursinus)*, © Riddellroo

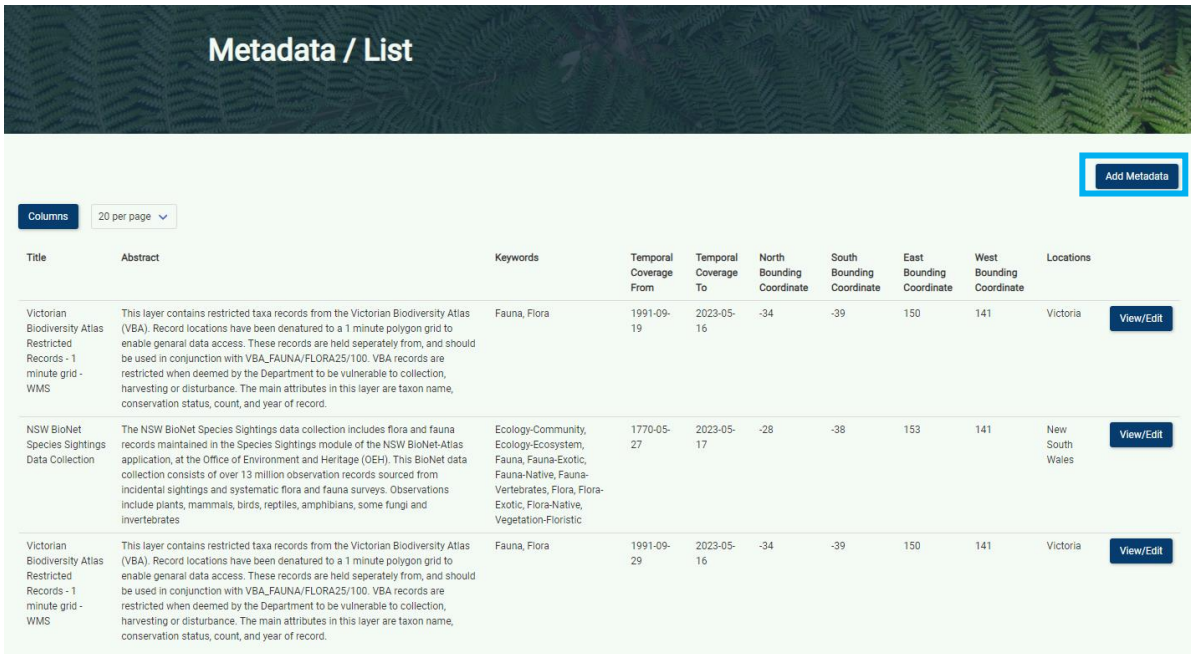
6. How to Add or Edit Metadata

(Data Custodians Only)

You can add or edit your metadata by logging into the portal and clicking on the “Manage Data” link under your tools (see screenshot below).



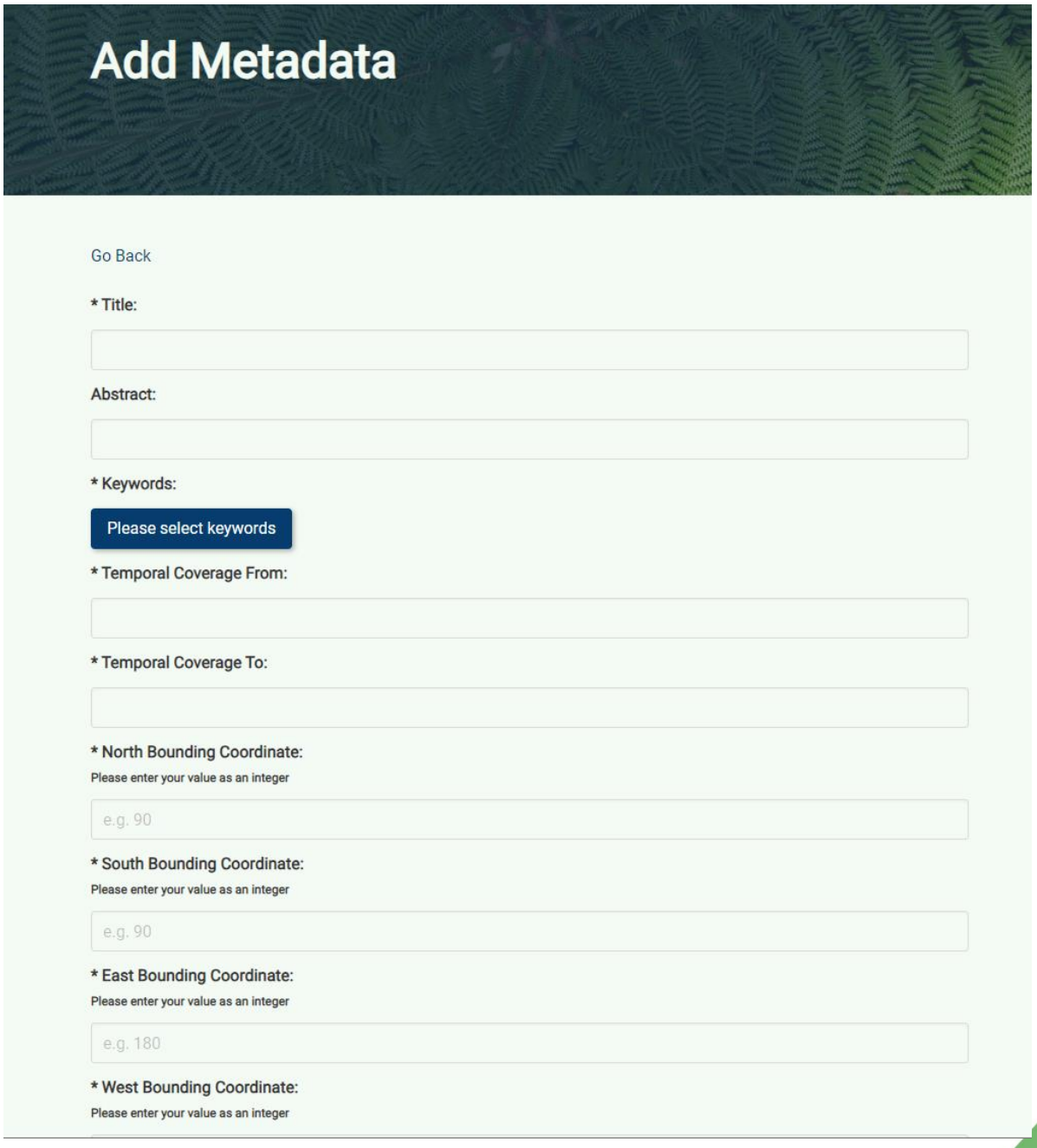
This will take you to the Metadata / List screen, an example of which is shown below.



Title	Abstract	Keywords	Temporal Coverage From	Temporal Coverage To	North Bounding Coordinate	South Bounding Coordinate	East Bounding Coordinate	West Bounding Coordinate	Locations	
Victorian Biodiversity Atlas Restricted Records - 1 minute grid - WMS	This layer contains restricted taxa records from the Victorian Biodiversity Atlas (VBA). Record locations have been denatured to a 1 minute polygon grid to enable genaral data access. These records are held seperately from, and should be used in conjunction with VBA_FAUNA/FLORA25/100. VBA records are restricted when deemed by the Department to be vulnerable to collection, harvesting or disturbance. The main attributes in this layer are taxon name, conservation status, count, and year of record.	Fauna, Flora	1991-09-19	2023-05-16	-34	-39	150	141	Victoria	View/Edit
NSW BioNet Species Sightings Data Collection	The NSW BioNet Species Sightings data collection includes flora and fauna records maintained in the Species Sightings module of the NSW BioNet-Atlas application, at the Office of Environment and Heritage (OEH). This BioNet data collection consists of over 13 million observation records sourced from incidental sightings and systematic flora and fauna surveys. Observations include plants, mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, some fungi and invertebrates	Ecology-Community, Ecology-Ecosystem, Fauna, Fauna-Exotic, Fauna-Native, Fauna-Vertebrates, Flora, Flora-Exotic, Flora-Native, Vegetation-Floristic	1770-05-27	2023-05-17	-28	-38	153	141	New South Wales	View/Edit
Victorian Biodiversity Atlas Restricted Records - 1 minute grid - WMS	This layer contains restricted taxa records from the Victorian Biodiversity Atlas (VBA). Record locations have been denatured to a 1 minute polygon grid to enable genaral data access. These records are held seperately from, and should be used in conjunction with VBA_FAUNA/FLORA25/100. VBA records are restricted when deemed by the Department to be vulnerable to collection, harvesting or disturbance. The main attributes in this layer are taxon name, conservation status, count, and year of record.	Fauna, Flora	1991-09-29	2023-05-16	-34	-39	150	141	Victoria	View/Edit

6.1 Adding a new metadata statement

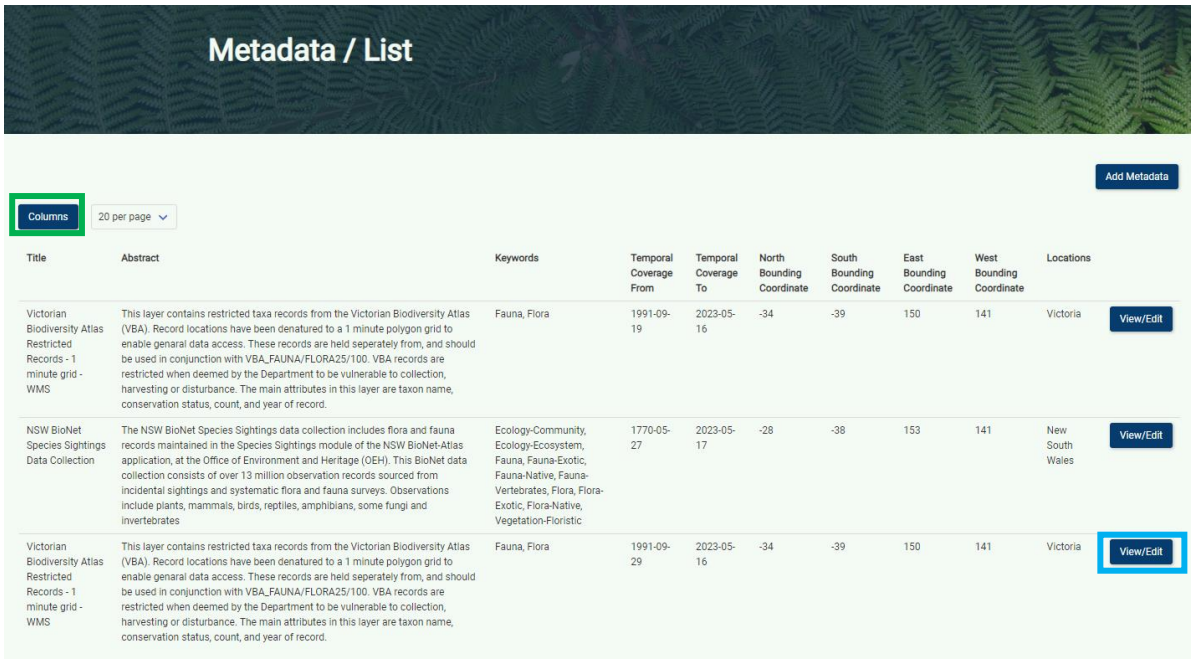
To add a new metadata statement for your dataset, click on the “Add Metadata” button highlighted in blue in the screenshot above. This will open up the metadata form (see screenshot below). All mandatory fields are asterisked. The form contains a mix of free text fields, drop-down menus and date fields. The drop-down menus either let you select multiple options or a single option. Once you have made you selection from each drop down, click elsewhere on the form for your selections to be applied.



Once all the mandatory fields are completed the “Add” button at the bottom of the metadata entry form will be enabled. When you click this button, your metadata will appear in your metadata list and also be searchable by the general public and able to be requested by registered data requestors.

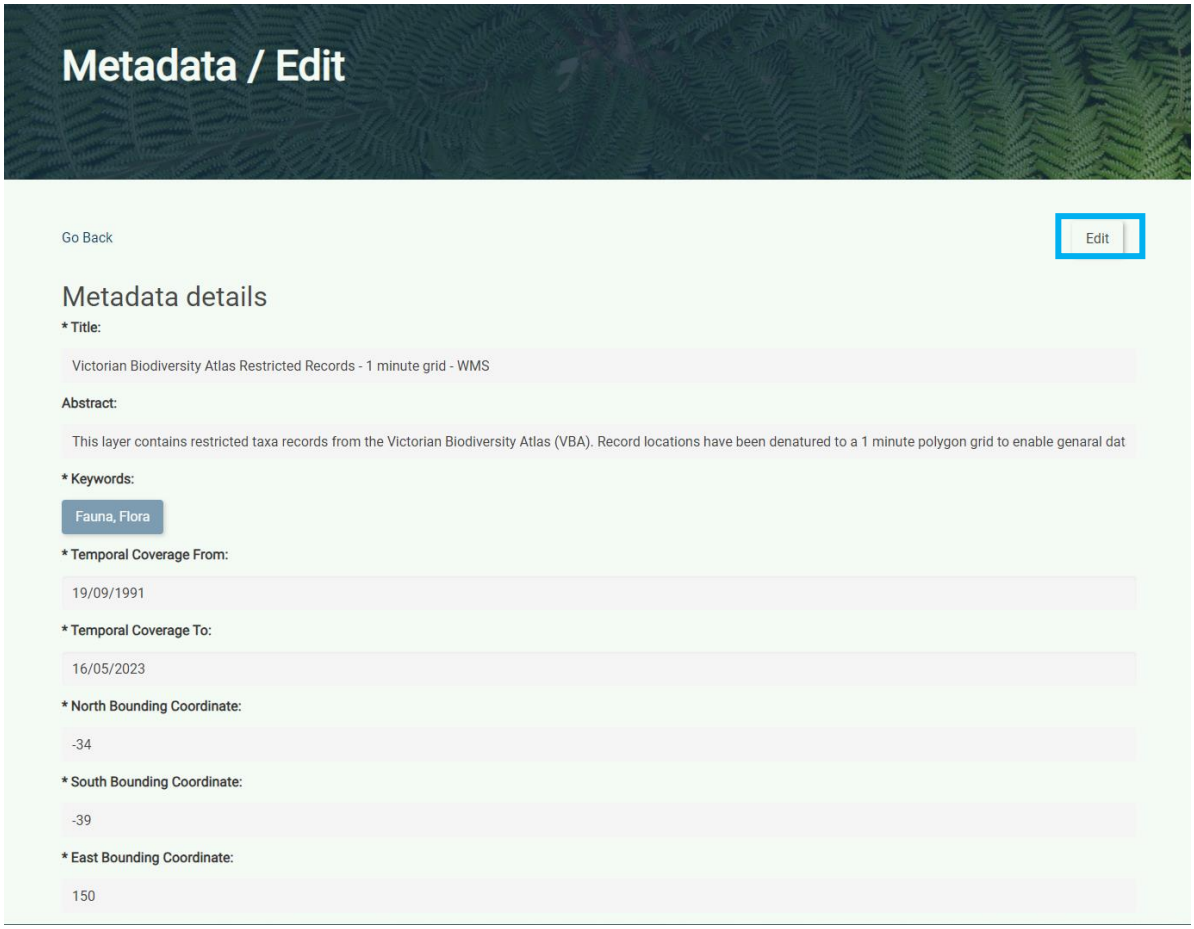
6.2 Updating / editing an existing metadata statement

To update an existing metadata statement for your data, you can either click on one of the metadata records in your metadata list or click on the “View / Edit” button – highlighted in blue below.



This will open up the individual metadata / edit form (example shown in the screenshot below). To edit the metadata record, click on the edit button either in the top right-hand corner of the form (highlighted in blue below) or at the bottom left-hand corner of the form. This will enable you to edit all details of the metadata. Once you’ve made changes, a green “Save” button will appear below the form. Click on this button and your updated metadata will be available for search both by the public and registered data requestors.

NOTE: you can change the metadata columns you can see in the Metadata / List view by clicking on the Columns button (highlighted green in the screenshot above) and selecting / deselecting columns.


Metadata / Edit
Go Back
Edit
Metadata details
* Title:
Victorian Biodiversity Atlas Restricted Records - 1 minute grid - WMS
Abstract:
This layer contains restricted taxa records from the Victorian Biodiversity Atlas (VBA). Record locations have been denatured to a 1 minute polygon grid to enable genaral dat
* Keywords:
Fauna, Flora
* Temporal Coverage From:
19/09/1991
* Temporal Coverage To:
16/05/2023
* North Bounding Coordinate:
-34
* South Bounding Coordinate:
-39
* East Bounding Coordinate:
150

This project is supported by the Australian Research Data Commons (ARDC). The ARDC is funded by NCRIS.







